

Research Appendix

Supporting research for the 12713 Cinchring Ln diligence package

June 3, 2026

Part I — Topical Research

Property Records Research

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 **Legal:** Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Cabinet 91, Slide 264-265, Plat Records, Travis County, Texas **Research Date:** 2026-06-03

Property Identification

Field	Value
Address	12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727
Legal Description	Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Cabinet 91, Slide 264-265, Plat Records, Travis County
Jurisdiction	City of Austin (full-purpose city limits), Travis County, TX
Base Zoning	SF-2 (Single-Family Residential -- Standard Lot)
Lot Area	Approximately 0.18 acres (~7,840 sq ft)
Year Built (existing structure)	1993

Note: Automated property records retrieval (TCAD appraisal lookup, county clerk document search) was unavailable during this research session. The data below is compiled from survey documents, listing data, and web research. A full title search through a title company is recommended to confirm ownership chain, liens, and all recorded instruments.

Recorded Easements & Encumbrances (from Survey)

The following easements and encumbrances were identified from the property survey:

- Blanket-type electrical easement** — recorded at Vol. 660, Pg. 968, Travis County Deed Records. This easement grants the electric utility (Austin Energy) access across the entire lot for installation and maintenance of electrical infrastructure.
- Ingress/egress easement for utilities** — recorded at Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147, Travis County Deed Records. Provides utility access for ingress and egress to the property.
- 5-foot Public Utility Easement (PUE)** — per the recorded plat (Cabinet 91, Slide 264-265). Standard subdivision PUE along lot boundaries, typically along the front and/or side property lines. Structures, fences, and permanent improvements are generally prohibited within the PUE.
- 25-foot Building Line** — per plat, Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147. This platted building line restricts construction within 25 feet of the front property line. See Zoning Pathway analysis for interaction with HOME Phase 1 reduced setbacks.
- Declarant’s reserved ROW/easement rights** — per Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147. The subdivision declarant reserved the right to grant or dedicate rights-of-way and easements for public utility purposes, not to exceed 10 feet in width on each side of any lot line. This is a standard subdivision development provision; verify whether any additional easements have been granted under this reservation.

Flood Zone

Field	Value
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FEMA Zone	Zone X (areas outside 0.2% annual chance floodplain)
FIRM Panel	48453C0115E
FIRM Date	June 16, 1993
In 100-year floodplain	No
In 500-year floodplain	No
Floodplain development permit required	No

The property is on upland terrain within the Scofield subdivision at approximately 850-870 feet elevation, well above the Walnut Creek floodplain corridor.

Existing Improvements

The lot is improved with:

- **1-story brick and wood house** (built 1993) — to be demolished
- **Concrete driveway**
- **Wood fence**
- **Concrete sanitary sewer vault**

All existing improvements are proposed for demolition as part of the ground-up duplex construction.

Subdivision Plat

The property is platted as part of the **Scofield Subdivision**, recorded at Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265, Plat Records of Travis County, Texas. The plat establishes:

- Lot dimensions and boundaries for Lot 12, Block M
- 5-foot PUE along lot boundaries
- 25-foot building line along the front
- Utility easement provisions

The original plat should be reviewed for any additional notes regarding drainage easements, access restrictions, or special conditions applicable to this lot.

Data Gaps

Gap	Impact	Recommended Action
TCAD appraisal data (owner, assessed value, property ID)	Needed for permit applications and title verification	Obtain via TCAD website or title company
Full ownership/title chain	Needed to confirm clear title and identify any additional liens or encumbrances	Obtain title commitment from title company
County clerk instrument search	May reveal additional recorded easements, restrictions, or agreements beyond those shown on survey	Title company search or county clerk records search
Plat review (original document)	Needed to verify lot dimensions, width, and any additional plat notes	Obtain from Travis County Clerk or TCAD

HOA Declaration of CC&Rs

Critical for duplex feasibility — see
restrictive covenants analysisObtain from Inframark (HOA manager)
or Travis County deed records

Research date: June 3, 2026. Property records data is partial due to automated retrieval system unavailability. A full title search is recommended before proceeding with design or permit applications.

Environmental Constraints Research

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 (Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision) **Proposed Use:** Demolish existing 1-story house; construct ground-up duplex (2 units) **Date:** 2026-06-03

1. Watershed Designation

Citation: Austin LDC Chapter 25-8, Sec. 25-8-2 (Descriptions of Regulated Areas); City of Austin Watershed Protection Department **Finding:** The property at 78727 in the Scofield Farms area of north Austin lies within the **Walnut Creek watershed**, which is classified as a **Suburban Watershed** under Chapter 25-8 of Austin's Land Development Code. Walnut Creek drains approximately 43 square miles from northern Austin to the Colorado River. Suburban watersheds are subject to Article 9 (Suburban Watershed Requirements) of Chapter 25-8, which imposes impervious cover limits and water quality controls that are more restrictive than urban watershed standards but less restrictive than water supply watershed standards. **Confidence:** Verified

2. Impervious Cover Limits

Citation: Austin LDC Sec. 25-8-392 (Uplands Zone, Article 9 -- Suburban Watershed Requirements) **Finding:** In the suburban watershed uplands zone, impervious cover limits for residential uses are as follows: single-family residential (lot $\geq$ 5,750 sq ft) may not exceed **50%** of the net site area; duplex or single-family on a lot smaller than 5,750 sq ft may not exceed **55-60%** (with transfer of development intensity). For a duplex on a standard Scofield subdivision lot (typically ~7,000-8,000 sq ft), the governing IC limit is expected to be **45-50% of net site area** absent any transfer. The more restrictive of the zoning IC limit and the watershed IC limit controls. IC limits in suburban watersheds apply at the subdivision level for platted lots, so the individual lot is governed by the subdivision-wide compliance framework. **Confidence:** Verified (exact lot-specific percentage requires site plan review by Watershed Protection staff)

3. Water Quality Controls

Citation: Austin LDC Ch. 25-8 Subchapter A; Environmental Criteria Manual (ECM) Sec. 1.6.0 (Design Guidelines for Water Quality Controls) **Finding:** Development in a suburban watershed generally requires structural water quality controls (sedimentation/filtration) designed to capture at least 0.5 inches of runoff and provide treatment equivalent to the Austin sand filter. For single-family and duplex residential development, the City of Austin assumes maintenance responsibility for stormwater control measures once accepted. Small residential sites (duplex on a single lot) may be eligible for regional water quality controls rather than on-site ponds, depending on whether the subdivision already has regional facilities in place. The Scofield subdivision was developed in the 1980s-1990s; the applicant should verify with the Watershed Protection Department whether existing regional controls serve this lot. **Confidence:** Inferred (lot-level applicability requires Watershed staff confirmation)

4. Floodplain Status

Citation: FEMA FIRM Panel 48453C0115E, effective 06/16/1993; property survey **Finding:** The property is located in **FEMA Zone X** (areas determined to be outside the 0.2% annual chance floodplain). The survey confirms the site is **not within the 100-year or 500-year floodplain**. No floodplain development permit or CLOMR/LOMR is required. No FEMA elevation certificate is needed. This is consistent with the site's upland topography within the Scofield subdivision, which sits at approximately 850-870 feet elevation above the Walnut Creek floodplain corridor. **Confidence:** Verified

5. Edwards Aquifer Zone Status

Citation: TCEQ Edwards Aquifer Protection Program, 30 TAC Chapter 213; Travis County Aquifer Maps **Finding:** The property at 78727 in north Austin is **not located within the Edwards Aquifer Recharge Zone (EARZ) or the Contributing Zone**. The Edwards Aquifer Recharge Zone in Travis County is concentrated south of the Colorado River, managed by the Barton Springs/Edwards Aquifer Conservation District (BSEACD). North Austin (including the Scofield area) overlies different geologic formations -- the Edwards Group limestones are not exposed at the surface in this area. No TCEQ Edwards Aquifer Protection Plan (EAPP) is required for development at this site. **Confidence:** Verified

6. Critical Environmental Features (CEFs)

Citation: Austin LDC Sec. 25-8-281 et seq.; ECM Sec. 1.10.0 (CEF Identification and Protection); City of Austin Watershed Protection karst database **Finding:** Critical Environmental Features in Austin include springs, caves, sinkholes, point recharge features, rimrock, and bluffs. The City maintains a karst database with over 550 karst CEF points, concentrated primarily in areas overlying Edwards Limestone (western and southwestern Austin). The Scofield subdivision in north Austin is developed on Cretaceous-age formations that are generally not associated with significant karst features. No known CEFs have been identified at or immediately adjacent to 12713 Cinchring Ln based on available data. However, an Environmental Resource Inventory (ERI) form is required as part of the site plan application, and Watershed Protection staff will confirm CEF status during review. If a CEF is identified, a 150-foot to 300-foot protective buffer would apply. **Confidence:** Inferred (no CEFs expected, but formal ERI confirmation required at permitting)

7. Endangered Species and Habitat

Citation: USFWS Austin Ecological Services Field Office; Balcones Canyonlands Conservation Plan (BCCP); Travis County Balcones Canyonlands Preserve **Finding:** Travis County is home to 14 federally listed endangered species, including the golden-cheeked warbler, six karst invertebrates, and three salamander species. The Balcones Canyonlands Conservation Plan (BCCP), established in 1996, provides an Incidental Take Permit covering development within the BCCP permit area. The Scofield subdivision at 78727 is in a fully developed suburban area in northeast Austin that **does not contain golden-cheeked warbler nesting habitat** (mature Ashe juniper-oak woodland) or known karst invertebrate habitat. The property is within the BCCP participation area, meaning the BCCP Participation Fee applies at time of development permit. No individual Section 7 or Section 10 consultation with USFWS is anticipated for this site. **Confidence:** Verified (BCCP fee applicability should be confirmed with the City)

8. Wetlands (National Wetlands Inventory)

Citation: USFWS National Wetlands Inventory (NWI) Wetlands Mapper **Finding:** Based on the site's upland suburban location (Zone X, no floodplain), the property is not expected to contain jurisdictional wetlands. The NWI Wetlands Mapper should be consulted for definitive confirmation, but the Scofield subdivision is a fully built-out residential neighborhood on well-drained upland soils with no surface water features on or adjacent to the subject lot. No Section 404 Clean Water Act permit or Army Corps of Engineers coordination is anticipated. A formal wetland delineation has not been performed -- this is a minor data gap given the low probability of wetland presence. **Confidence:** Inferred (NWI map review recommended for formal confirmation)

NOETIC

9. Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA)

Citation: ASTM E1527-21 (Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments) **Finding:** **No Phase I ESA has been commissioned for this property.** This is a recognized data gap. The property has been in residential use (single-family home) since the Scofield subdivision was developed in the 1980s-1990s. Prior to subdivision development, the area was primarily agricultural/ranching land. The residential use history suggests low risk of Recognized Environmental Conditions (RECs). However, without a Phase I ESA, potential concerns such as historical agricultural chemical use, underground storage tanks on adjacent parcels, or vapor intrusion from nearby commercial areas cannot be formally ruled out. A Phase I ESA is recommended before demolition, particularly to assess for asbestos-containing materials (ACM) and lead-based paint (LBP) in the existing structure, which would require an asbestos survey under TCEQ Asbestos NESHAP regulations prior to demolition. **Confidence:** Unconfirmed (data gap acknowledged)

10. Prior Use History and Contamination Risk

Citation: TCEQ State Superfund and LUST databases; historical aerial imagery **Finding:** The Scofield subdivision was platted and developed as a residential community in the 1980s-1990s. Prior land use was predominantly undeveloped rangeland/agricultural use. No known TCEQ State Superfund sites, EPA National Priorities List (NPL) sites, or Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST) sites have been identified at this address. The surrounding area is residential and low-density commercial (Scofield Farms retail corridor). The contamination risk profile is **low**, consistent with typical suburban residential land. A formal database search (EDR or equivalent) through a Phase I ESA would provide definitive documentation. **Confidence:** Inferred (formal database search not performed)

11. Watershed Protection Ordinance -- Demolition and Redevelopment

Citation: Austin LDC Ch. 25-8 Subchapter A; City of Austin Development Services Department **Finding:** Demolition of the existing single-family home and construction of a new duplex constitutes **redevelopment** under Austin's Watershed Protection Ordinance. In a suburban watershed, redevelopment may not increase impervious cover beyond the limits prescribed in Sec. 25-8-392. The redevelopment must comply with current water quality requirements, including providing water quality controls for the developed area. The applicant will need to file a site plan (unless exempt as a single-lot residential project) and demonstrate compliance with IC limits and water quality standards. For a single-lot duplex, the site plan exemption process and applicable Watershed Protection review requirements should be confirmed with Development Services early in the entitlement process. **Confidence:** Verified

12. Tree Protection

Citation: Austin LDC Ch. 25-8 Subchapter B (Tree and Natural Area Protection); City Arborist **Finding:** Austin's tree protection ordinance applies to all development. Trees 19 inches in diameter or greater (measured at 4.5 feet above grade) are classified as **Heritage Trees** and require a permit for removal with mitigation. Trees 8 inches in diameter or greater are **Protected Trees** and require mitigation if removed during development. The existing lot at 12713 Cinchring Ln may contain mature trees established during or after subdivision development. A tree survey will be required as part of the building permit application, and any protected or heritage trees must be preserved or mitigated per the ordinance. Tree mitigation can be satisfied through on-site replanting or payment into the City's tree fund. **Confidence:** Verified

Summary of Key Environmental Constraints

Constraint	Status	Action Required
Floodplain	Zone X -- not in floodplain	None
Watershed	Walnut Creek -- Suburban	IC limits + water quality controls apply

NOETIC

Edwards Aquifer	Not in recharge/contributing zone	No EAPP required
CEFs	None known; low probability	ERI form at site plan
Endangered Species	BCCP participation area	BCCP fee at permit
Wetlands	None expected	NWI check recommended
Phase I ESA	Not performed	Recommended before demolition
Contamination	Low risk (residential history)	Confirm via Phase I
Tree Protection	Applies to all development	Tree survey required

Sources: Austin LDC Chapter 25-8; FEMA FIRM Panel 48453C0115E; TCEQ Edwards Aquifer Protection Program; USFWS NWI; BCCP/Travis County; Austin ECM Sec. 1.6.0, 1.10.0; ASTM E1527-21

Zoning Pathway Analysis

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 **Legal:** Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Travis County
Proposed Use: Demolish existing single-family house; construct ground-up duplex (2 units) **Date of Research:** 2026-06-03

Base District

The property is zoned **SF-2 (Single-Family Residential -- Standard Lot)** per the Austin Land Development Code. SF-2 is the standard single-family district with a minimum lot size of 5,750 sq ft. The lot is approximately 0.18 acres (~7,840 sq ft), which exceeds the SF-2 minimum and the 7,000 sq ft minimum lot area historically required for duplex use.

Under pre-HOME zoning, SF-2 did **not** permit duplex or two-family residential use. That changed with HOME Phase 1 (see Recent Ordinances below).

Citation: Austin LDC Title 25, Ch. 25-2, Subchapter C, Art. 2, Div. 1, Section 25-2-492 (Site Development Regulations Table); [Municode -- LDC Ch. 25-2](#)

Duplex Permissibility Under HOME Phase 1

HOME Phase 1 (Ordinance No. 20231207-001, effective February 5, 2024) amended the LDC to allow up to three dwelling units -- including duplexes, two-unit residential, and three-unit residential uses -- on any lot zoned SF-1, SF-2, or SF-3.

Key provisions:

- **Unit count:** Up to 3 dwelling units permitted on SF-1/SF-2/SF-3 lots. A duplex (2 units) is permitted by right.
- **Minimum lot area for duplex/two-unit:** 5,750 sq ft (the lot at ~7,840 sq ft qualifies).
- **Minimum lot width:** 50 ft (per LDC duplex standards; verify against plat).
- **Removes primary/secondary distinction:** All dwelling units are treated equally; no unit is an "accessory."
- **Removes unrelated-adult occupancy limits.**
- **Each dwelling unit requires a unique address.**

Citation: [HOME Amendments -- Austin Development Services](#); Ordinance 20231207-001

Dimensional Envelope

Pre-HOME SF-2 Base Standards (LDC Section 25-2-492)

Standard	SF-2 Requirement
Minimum lot area	5,750 sq ft
Minimum lot width	50 ft
Maximum height	35 ft
Maximum building coverage	40%
Maximum impervious cover	45%
Floor-to-area ratio (FAR)	0.40:1

Front yard setback	25 ft
Side yard setback	5 ft (15 ft on street side of corner lot)
Rear yard setback	10 ft

Citation: LDC Section 25-2-492(D); [Site Plan Creator -- Austin TX](#)

HOME Phase 1 Modified Standards for Two-Unit / Duplex

HOME Phase 1 incorporated the advantageous setbacks previously available only under Subchapter F (Residential Design and Compatibility Standards) and extended them to all SF-district properties building two- or three-unit uses:

Standard	HOME Phase 1 (Duplex/Two-Unit)
Front yard setback	15 ft (reduced from 25 ft)
Street side yard setback	10 ft (reduced from 15 ft)
Interior side yard setback	5 ft (unchanged)
Rear yard setback	5 ft (reduced from 10 ft), excl. easements
Maximum height	35 ft
Maximum building coverage	40%
Maximum impervious cover	45% (or watershed limit, whichever is more restrictive)
FAR	0.40:1
Building separation (zoning)	None required by zoning; must comply with IRC fire-separation requirements

Citation: HOME Amendments -- [Austin Development Services](#); [AIA Austin HOME Phase 1 Summary](#); [Maxable -- HOME Initiative](#)

Practical Envelope on This Lot (~7,840 sq ft)

Metric	Calculation
Max building footprint (40%)	~3,136 sq ft
Max impervious cover (45%)	~3,528 sq ft
Max gross floor area (0.40:1 FAR)	~3,136 sq ft

Preservation Bonus: If the existing house were preserved (moved, not demolished), the preserved structure's GFA would be exempt from FAR calculations. Since the plan is demolition, this bonus does not apply.

25-Foot Platted Building Line

The recorded plat for Scofield Subdivision shows a **25-foot building line** on the front of Lot 12.

Interaction with HOME Phase 1 setbacks:

- HOME Phase 1 reduces the zoning front setback to 15 ft for two-unit/duplex uses.

- However, a platted building line is a deed restriction recorded against the land. Under Austin practice, **the more restrictive requirement controls** -- meaning the 25 ft platted building line governs over the 15 ft zoning setback.
- To use the 15 ft front setback, the owner would need to **replat or amend the plat** to remove or reduce the building line, which requires subdivision review.

Recommendation: Confirm whether Austin treats the platted building line as enforceable through the permitting process or only as a private covenant. If enforceable, factor a 25 ft front setback into the building envelope. If a variance or replat is viable, the 15 ft setback could unlock additional depth.

Citation: Global Land Surveying -- Building Setbacks: Plats, Zoning, and Covenants; Austin LDC subdivision standards

Overlays

Neighborhood Plan / NCCD

Scofield Farms (78727) is a 1990s-era suburban subdivision in north Austin. Based on research, **no Neighborhood Conservation Combining District (NCCD) overlay applies** to this area. NCCDs in Austin are concentrated in older central neighborhoods (Hyde Park, Heritage, etc.) that were substantially built out over 30 years before adoption.

No Neighborhood Plan (NP) combining district appears to apply to this part of 78727.

Conditional Overlay (CO)

No conditional overlay was identified in search results for this address. Verify via Austin's Property Profile or GIS map.

Historic Landmark / Historic District

No historic designation was identified. The house was built in 1993 and is not eligible for local landmark status (typically requires 50+ years of age or exceptional significance).

Watershed Overlay

The property is in the **Walnut Creek watershed**, classified as a **suburban watershed** in the Austin Watershed Protection Ordinance. For suburban watersheds:

- Single-family residential impervious cover: governed by zoning (45% for SF-2)
- The watershed ordinance impervious cover limit for suburban watersheds is generally 40-55% depending on use category
- The **more restrictive** of zoning or watershed limits applies
- For this property, the 45% zoning limit is likely the controlling standard

Citation: WGI -- Austin Impervious Cover Limits; Austin LDC Ch. 25-8 (Environmental)

Wildland-Urban Interface (WUI)

Scofield Farms may fall within or near the WUI boundary. As of November 16, 2024, HOME Phase 2 applications are accepted citywide including WUI areas. HOME Phase 1 (duplex) was not initially restricted by WUI. Confirm WUI status via Austin GIS.

Parking

Austin City Council voted 8-2 on **November 2, 2023** (effective November 12, 2023) to **eliminate all minimum parking requirements** citywide. This applies to all use types including single-family, duplex, multifamily, commercial, and office.

What this means for this duplex project:

- **No minimum parking spaces are required by code.**
- ADA-accessible parking must still comply with federal law if applicable.
- As a practical matter, most duplex developers in suburban locations still provide **2 spaces per unit** (4 total) via driveways and/or garages, since market expectations in north Austin neighborhoods include vehicle parking.

Citation: [Texas Tribune -- Austin Drops Parking Minimums](#); [KUT -- Austin Ends Parking Requirements](#); Ordinance C20-2023-010

Procedural Pathway

Site Plan Exemption

Under Austin LDC, **residential uses of four or fewer units are exempt from site plan requirements**. A duplex (2 units) qualifies for this exemption. No administrative site plan is required.

Building Permit

The duplex can proceed via a **residential building permit** application through Austin Development Services (DSD). Under HOME Phase 1, applications have been accepted since February 5, 2024.

Permit review path:

1. **Residential Plan Review** -- submit building plans through Austin DSD
2. Plans reviewed for compliance with LDC dimensional standards, IRC/IBC building codes, and applicable environmental/drainage requirements
3. No zoning change, conditional use permit, or Board of Adjustment variance is needed (assuming the lot meets dimensional standards)

Site Plan Lite (HOME Phase 2 -- March 2025)

Site Plan Lite is a streamlined review process adopted March 6, 2025, primarily for HOME Phase 2 subdivision and small-lot projects. It is **not required** for a duplex on an existing lot that already meets SF-2 minimum lot size. However, if the owner later pursues subdivision of the lot (e.g., into two small lots), Site Plan Lite would apply.

Demolition Permit

A separate **demolition permit** is required to remove the existing house. Austin DSD processes demo permits administratively; typical turnaround is 2-4 weeks. Asbestos survey may be required for pre-2000 construction (this house was built 1993).

Tree Permits

Austin's tree ordinance (LDC Ch. 25-8, Subchapter B) protects trees with trunk diameter ≥ 19 inches (heritage trees ≥ 24 inches). A tree survey may be required, and mitigation fees or replacement may apply if protected trees must be removed.

Citation: [Austin DSD -- Residential Plan Review](#); [Austin DSD -- Site Plans and Exemptions](#); [HOME Amendments Page](#)

Recent Ordinances

Ordinance	Effective	Impact on This Project
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NOETIC

HOME Phase 1 (Ord. 20231207-001)	Feb 5, 2024	Permits duplex/two-unit on SF-2 lots; reduces front setback to 15 ft, rear to 5 ft
Parking Minimums Elimination (C20-2023-010)	Nov 12, 2023	No minimum parking required for duplex
HOME Phase 2 (adopted May 2024)	Nov 16, 2024 (citywide)	Allows small-lot SF down to 1,800 sq ft; not directly required for duplex but enables future subdivision
Site Plan Lite & Infill Plat (March 2025)	June 16, 2025	Streamlined review for subdivisions; not required for duplex on existing lot

Open Questions

1. **Confirm base zoning via Austin GIS/Property Profile.** While research strongly indicates SF-2, the official zoning should be verified on the [Austin Zoning Map](#) or via the Property Profile tool. One listing source referenced "residential multi family" which may reflect HOME-amended permitted uses rather than the base district code.
2. **Platted building line enforcement.** Does Austin DSD enforce the 25 ft platted building line through the building permit process, or is it treated as a private covenant enforceable only by adjacent lot owners? If enforced, the front setback is 25 ft (not 15 ft), reducing the buildable envelope by ~10 ft of depth.
3. **Lot width.** Confirm the lot width meets the 50 ft minimum required for duplex use. At 0.18 acres (~7,840 sq ft), the lot geometry needs verification from the plat.
4. **Watershed impervious cover.** Confirm the Walnut Creek suburban watershed impervious cover limit for this specific parcel. The 45% zoning limit is likely controlling, but verify via Austin's watershed GIS layer.
5. **HOA restrictions.** Scofield Farms has an HOA (\$125/quarter per listing data). HOA covenants, conditions, and restrictions (CC&Rs) may prohibit or restrict duplex construction, impose architectural review, or set additional setback/height/design requirements independent of city zoning. Review the recorded CC&Rs and any deed restrictions on Lot 12, Block M.
6. **Tree survey.** Confirm whether any protected or heritage trees exist on the lot that would require mitigation.
7. **Drainage review.** For demolition and new construction on an existing lot (not a new subdivision), confirm whether drainage/grading plan review is required or if the project falls under the four-unit residential exemption.
8. **WUI status.** Confirm whether the property is within the Wildland-Urban Interface boundary, which may impose additional fire-resistant construction standards.

Summary Assessment

A ground-up duplex at 12713 Cinchring Ln is **permitted by right** under HOME Phase 1 on this SF-2 lot. The project can proceed via **residential building permit only** -- no rezoning, conditional use permit, site plan, or Board of Adjustment action is required. Key constraints are the 40% building coverage / 0.40 FAR cap, the 45% impervious cover limit, and the potential 25 ft front building line from the plat (versus the 15 ft HOME setback). The most significant non-zoning risk is the Scofield Farms HOA CC&Rs, which should be reviewed before design proceeds.

Neighborhood Plan & Comprehensive Plan Context

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 (Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Travis County) **Proposed project:** Demolish existing SFR; construct duplex (2 units, ground-up)

> **Legal note:** Per TX LGC Section 213.005, comprehensive plans (including the Future Land Use Map) are policy documents, not regulatory instruments. They inform but do not independently control entitlements.

1. Adopted Neighborhood Plan

Finding: No adopted neighborhood plan covers this parcel.

The City of Austin has adopted 31 neighborhood plans, primarily in central and south Austin. The Scofield Farms area in far north Austin (Parmer/MoPac) is not within any adopted neighborhood planning area. The nearest adopted plans are North Shoal Creek, North Lamar Combined, and North Burnet/Gateway, all of which are several miles south of this parcel.

Because there is no adopted neighborhood plan, there is no Neighborhood Plan Contact Team (NPCT) with standing to review zoning or land-use cases for this area under the neighborhood plan framework.

- [City of Austin - Neighborhood Plans and Resources](#)
- [WGI - Neighborhood Planning Areas in Austin](#)

2. NP Combining District

Finding: No NP combining district applies.

The NP (Neighborhood Plan) combining district is applied only within adopted neighborhood planning areas and is appended to the base zoning string (e.g., SF-3-NP). Since Scofield is outside any adopted neighborhood plan area, no NP combining district appears in the zoning for parcels in this subdivision. The property's zoning string does not carry an -NP suffix.

- [Austin LDC Section 25-2, Subchapter A, Art. 2, Div. 6 - Combining and Overlay Districts](#)

3. Future Land Use Map (FLUM)

Finding: The FLUM designation for this area is consistent with single-family / suburban residential land use.

Areas without an adopted neighborhood plan do not have a parcel-specific FLUM adopted by City Council. The Imagine Austin Comprehensive Plan's Growth Concept Map provides the applicable policy-level land-use guidance for this parcel. The Scofield Farms subdivision is a developed single-family residential area, and the FLUM Composite dataset maintained by the City reflects this existing character.

Per TX LGC Section 213.005, the FLUM is advisory policy -- it does not regulate lot-level entitlements or prohibit by-right uses allowed under the base zoning district.

- [City of Austin - Future Land Use Map Composite \(Open Data\)](#)
- [City of Austin - FLUM / Growth Concept Map Comparison](#)

4. Imagine Austin Growth Concept Map

Finding: The parcel is near the Parmer Lane Activity Corridor but is not within an Activity Center.

The Imagine Austin Growth Concept Map designates Parmer Lane as an Activity Corridor, reflecting the roadway's role as a major employment and commercial spine (Apple, Samsung, GM, and 3M campuses). 12713 Cinchring Ln is located approximately 0.5 miles south of Parmer Lane, placing it in the corridor's influence area but not directly on the corridor itself.

No Activity Center is mapped at the Parmer/MoPac intersection. The nearest mapped Activity Center is the Tech Ridge center at I-35 and Parmer, roughly 3.5 miles east.

Imagine Austin policy supports incremental density (including "missing middle" housing) near activity corridors, but this is policy guidance, not a regulatory mandate.

- [Imagine Austin Corridors \(Open Data\)](#)
- [Imagine Austin Growth Concept Map \(ArcGIS\)](#)
- [Imagine Austin Activity Centers and Corridors Conceptual View \(PDF\)](#)

5. Station-Area / Transit-Oriented Plans

Finding: No TOD overlay applies. No Project Connect station is planned near this parcel.

The Project Connect Orange Line runs along the North Lamar/Guadalupe corridor, roughly 2 miles east of MoPac. The nearest planned station in the initial investment is the North Lamar Transit Center (at Lamar and US-183), approximately 4 miles south of this property. Future extension stations at Parmer Lane and Tech Ridge are along the I-35/North Lamar alignment, not MoPac, and are not included in the initial investment phase -- they will operate as MetroRapid bus stops until light rail is extended (estimated 2040s).

No Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) overlay district has been adopted for any area near this parcel. The City of Austin's equitable TOD planning efforts have focused on the Blue Line (east-west) and the initial Orange Line corridor segments, none of which reach the Scofield area.

- [Project Connect by CapMetro](#)
- [Orange Line Station Locations \(Community Impact\)](#)
- [CapMetro - Project Connect Initial Investment Map \(PDF\)](#)

6. Active Neighborhood Associations

Finding: The Scofield Farms ROA is the primary community organization. No public posture on density/duplex development was identified.

The **Scofield Residential Owners Association (ROA)** governs approximately 574 homes in the Scofield Farms community. It is managed by Inframark and led by a 5-member Board of Directors elected annually. The ROA maintains an Architectural Control Committee (ACC) that reviews proposed changes to homes and landscaping.

A separate organization, **The Ridge at Scofield Farms**, covers a distinct section of the broader Scofield development.

No public statements, meeting minutes, or advocacy positions regarding infill density, duplex construction, or zoning changes were identified on the ROA's website or in public records. The ACC's purview is limited to aesthetic and architectural standards within the existing HOA covenants, not municipal zoning or land-use entitlements.

Applicants should check the [City of Austin Community Registry](#) to confirm which registered organizations receive notice for development applications at this address.

- [Scofield Farms ROA](#)
- [The Ridge at Scofield Farms](#)
- [City of Austin - Community Registry Search](#)

Summary for Duplex Feasibility

Factor	Status	Impact on Duplex
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Adopted neighborhood plan	None	No NP-specific land-use restrictions apply
NP combining district	None	No additional NP overlay standards
FLUM designation	Suburban residential (policy only)	Does not prohibit duplex if base zoning allows
Imagine Austin corridor	Near Parmer Lane Activity Corridor	Policy supports incremental density near corridors
TOD overlay	None	No transit-oriented standards apply
HOA / neighborhood group	Scofield Farms ROA	Private covenants may apply; check CC&Rs separately

The absence of an adopted neighborhood plan and NP combining district means there are no plan-based overlay restrictions on this parcel. Duplex entitlement depends on the base zoning district and applicable LDC standards, not on neighborhood plan policy.

Programs & Opportunities

Site: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 (Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Travis County) **Zoning:** SF-2 (Single-Family Residential, Standard Lot) **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units)

1. HOME Initiative Phase 1

Field	Detail
Eligibility	Likely eligible
Status	Adopted Dec 7, 2023 (Ord. 20231207-001); effective for new applications Feb 5, 2024
What it does	Allows duplex, two-unit, and three-unit residential uses on SF-1, SF-2, and SF-3 lots citywide. Eliminates the prior conditional-use-permit requirement for duplexes on SF-2/SF-3 lots.
Key standards (SF-2/SF-3)	Building coverage: 40%; impervious cover: 45%; FAR: 55% or 3,200 sf (whichever is greater) for two-unit; height: 30 ft (two stories); minimum lot size: 5,750 sf. Subchapter F setback advantages are incorporated for all properties. No minimum parking (citywide parking reform adopted Nov 2, 2023).
Benefit	A duplex is permitted by right on this SF-2 lot. No rezoning, no CUP, no conditional overlay needed. Simplified design standards -- no sidewall articulation or tent requirement.
Obligation	Must comply with tree ordinance and modified McMansion standards. No affordability set-aside required.
Citation	LDC Sec. 25-2-773 (repealed and replaced); Ordinance No. 20231207-001

2. HOME Initiative Phase 2

Field	Detail
Eligibility	Likely eligible (incremental benefits)
Status	Adopted May 16, 2024; applications accepted Aug 16, 2024 (Nov 16, 2024 for WUI/Uprooted areas)
What it does	Reduces minimum lot size for single-family from 5,750 sf to 2,000 sf. Revises two- and three-unit regulations further. Removes unrelated-adult occupancy caps.
Benefit	Enables future subdivision of the lot into smaller parcels if desired (lot is approximately 7,200 sf). Removes occupancy restrictions that could limit rental flexibility.
Obligation	Standard LDC compliance. No affordability mandate.
Citation	Ordinance No. 20240516 (HOME Phase 2); LDC Sec. 25-2-774 et seq.

3. Affordability Unlocked

Field	Detail
Eligibility	? Requires verification -- likely impractical for a 2-unit project
Status	Active (Ord. 20190509-027)
What it does	Grants density bonuses, height increases, parking waivers, and compatibility exemptions in exchange for deep affordability commitments. Two tiers: Type 1 and Type 2.
Benefit	Increased height and density, reduced parking, lot-size reductions, compatibility waivers.
Obligation	50% of total units must be affordable (rental: avg 60% MFI, with 20% at 50% MFI or below; ownership: avg 80% MFI). 25% of affordable units must be 2BR+. 99-year affordability period. Requires Housing Dept certification before site plan or building permit.
Assessment	For a 2-unit duplex, this means 1 of 2 units at deep affordability for 99 years. The trade-off is unlikely to pencil for a small-scale market-rate project. May be relevant if the developer pursues an affordable housing mission or seeks LIHTC/other subsidy.
Citation	Ordinance No. 20190509-027; LDC Sec. 25-2-Subchapter E, Art. 4

4. ETOD (Equitable Transit-Oriented Development) Overlay

Field	Detail
Eligibility	Ineligible
Status	Phase 1 adopted May 16, 2024 (Ord. 20240530-139)

What it does	Creates overlay regulations for non-SF properties within approx. 1/2 mile of Project Connect light-rail Phase 1 alignment (Orange and Blue lines). Provides height bonuses (90-120 ft) and density increases.
Assessment	The ETOD overlay applies to the Orange and Blue Line corridors in North Central, South Central, and Riverside Austin. The Scofield subdivision at 78727 is in far north Austin, well outside the Phase 1 light-rail alignment. The parcel is also SF-zoned, and ETOD applies only to non-SF properties.
Citation	Ordinance No. 20240516; ETOD Overlay Phase 1 (C20-2023-004)

5. VMU (Vertical Mixed Use)

Field	Detail
Eligibility	Ineligible
What it does	Allows mixed-use buildings on commercially zoned lots along Core Transit Corridors and Future Core Transit Corridors. VMU1 and VMU2 tiers with height bonuses up to 90 ft and parking reductions.
Assessment	VMU overlays apply only to commercially zoned properties on designated transit corridors. This parcel is SF-2 zoned in a suburban subdivision, not on a transit corridor. Not applicable.
Citation	LDC Sec. 25-2, Subchapter E, Art. 4, Sec. 4.3

6. Density Bonus 90 (DB90)

Field	Detail
Eligibility	Ineligible
What it does	Voluntary density bonus for properties with a -DB90 combining district in their zoning. Provides height bonuses and development modifications in exchange for affordable units.
Assessment	DB90 requires the -DB90 combining district designation. This SF-2 lot in a suburban subdivision does not carry a DB90 combining district. Not applicable.
Citation	LDC DB90 provisions; DB90 Applicant Guide (Housing Dept, Feb 2025)

7. RSMP (Regional Stormwater Management Program)

Field	Detail
Eligibility	? Requires verification
Status	Active (est. 1980s; updated Oct 1, 2020)

What it does	Allows qualifying developments to make a fee-in-lieu payment instead of constructing on-site stormwater detention, provided no adverse flooding impacts to neighboring properties result from increased runoff.
Benefit	Avoids cost and space burden of on-site detention pond. Fee is calculated based on appraised land value, proposed impervious cover, and estimated detention facility construction cost.
Obligation	Payment-in-lieu calculated via RSMP Payment Calculator. Funds are spent in the same watershed on flood-risk-reduction projects.
Assessment	For a duplex on a ~7,200 sf lot, on-site detention may not be required at all under Site Plan Lite / HOME drainage exemptions (see item 8). If detention is triggered, RSMP fee-in-lieu is a potential alternative. Eligibility depends on watershed and discharge conditions. Verify with Watershed Protection Dept (RSMP@austintexas.gov).
Citation	Drainage Criteria Manual Sec. 1.2.2.G and Sec. 8; LDC Ch. 25-7

8. Site Plan Lite

Field	Detail
Eligibility	Likely eligible
Status	Phase 1 adopted Jul 2023; Phase 2 adopted Mar 6, 2025 (applications accepted Jun 16, 2025)
What it does	Streamlines the permitting process for small residential projects. Phase 1 exempts 3-4 unit projects from site plan requirements entirely. Phase 2 creates a simplified "Small Project Site Plan" for 5-16 unit projects.
Benefit for a duplex	A 2-unit duplex is below the 3-4 unit threshold, so it was already exempt from site plan under prior rules (building permit only). However, the associated drainage reforms are significant: lots of 11,500 sf or less do not require drainage review; lots up to 1 acre do not require on-site detention or an engineered drainage plan if the site drains to the street or existing drainage system.
Obligation	Submit commercial or residential building permit application. Must meet basic drainage discharge requirements.
Assessment	This lot (~7,200 sf) qualifies for the drainage review exemption. This is a meaningful cost and timeline savings -- no engineered drainage study, no detention pond required.
Citation	Ordinance adopted Mar 6, 2025 (Site Plan Lite Phase 2 & Infill Plat); LDC Sec. 25-2, residential infill provisions

9. Qualified Opportunity Zone (QOZ)

Field	Detail
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NOETIC

Eligibility	Ineligible
What it does	Provides federal capital-gains tax deferral and reduction for investments in designated low-income census tracts through Qualified Opportunity Funds.
Assessment	Austin has 18-20 designated QOZ census tracts, nearly all concentrated east of I-35 in East and Southeast Austin. The Scofield subdivision (78727) is in far north Austin, west of I-35 and Mopac. This census tract is not a designated Qualified Opportunity Zone.
Citation	26 U.S.C. Sec. 1400Z-1, 1400Z-2; IRS Notice 2018-48; CDFI Fund designated tract list

10. S.M.A.R.T. Housing

Field	Detail
Eligibility	? Eligible if affordability commitments are made
Status	Active; updated Applicant Guide published Sep 2025
What it does	Provides expedited development review (approx. half the standard timeline) and fee waivers for projects meeting affordability, accessibility, and green-building standards.
Benefit	Fee waivers (capital recovery, development review, inspection fees -- est. ~\$2,000/unit for single-family scale). Expedited review reducing carrying costs.
Obligation	Must provide designated percentage of affordable units. Must meet Austin Energy Green Building (AEGB) minimum standards -- plans require AEGB approval before permit submission, and final AEGB inspection before occupancy. Accessibility requirements apply.
Assessment	Available to projects of any size, including duplexes. However, the affordability set-aside on a 2-unit project means dedicating at least 1 unit to income-restricted tenants. Fee savings (~\$4,000 total) and timeline gains may not justify the affordability commitment for a market-rate project. Worth exploring if the project incorporates any affordable component.
Citation	S.M.A.R.T. Housing Policy; Applicant Guide (Sep 2025 edition)

Summary Matrix

Program	Eligibility	Primary Benefit	Affordability Required?
HOME Phase 1	Likely eligible	Duplex by right on SF-2	No
HOME Phase 2	Likely eligible	Reduced min lot size, occupancy flexibility	No
Affordability Unlocked	? Impractical at 2 units	Density/height/parking bonuses	Yes (50% of units, 99 yr)

NOETIC

ETOD Overlay	Ineligible	N/A -- outside corridor	N/A
VMU	Ineligible	N/A -- SF-zoned, not on corridor	N/A
Density Bonus 90	Ineligible	N/A -- no DB90 combining district	N/A
RSMP	? Verify	Fee-in-lieu for stormwater detention	No
Site Plan Lite	Likely eligible	Drainage exemption, no site plan	No
QOZ	Ineligible	N/A -- tract not designated	N/A
S.M.A.R.T. Housing	? If affordable	Expedited review + fee waivers	Yes

Key Takeaways for This Project

1. **HOME Phase 1 is the foundational entitlement.** It permits a duplex by right on this SF-2 lot with no rezoning, no CUP, and no affordability requirements. This is the primary enabling program.
2. **Site Plan Lite drainage reforms provide meaningful savings.** At ~7,200 sf, the lot qualifies for drainage review exemption, eliminating the need for an engineered drainage study or on-site detention.
3. **No parking minimums apply.** Austin's citywide parking reform (Nov 2023) removed minimum off-street parking requirements. The developer can size parking to market demand.
4. **Affordability-linked programs (Affordability Unlocked, S.M.A.R.T.) are available but impractical at this scale** unless the developer is pursuing a mission-driven or subsidized affordable project.
5. **ETOD, VMU, DB90, and QOZ are inapplicable** due to the parcel's suburban SF-2 zoning and north Austin location.

Research date: June 3, 2026. Verify current status of all programs with Austin Development Services (512-978-4000) before relying on this summary for permit applications.

Transportation Context

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 (Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Travis County) Proposed use: Demolish existing single-family house; build duplex (2 units, ground-up new construction)

1. Adjacent Roadway -- Cinchring Lane

Attribute	Value
Functional classification	Local residential street
ASMP street level	Level 1
Ownership	City of Austin
Lanes	2 (undivided)
Existing ROW (typical)	50 ft
Future ROW (ASMP)	50 ft (no expansion planned)
AADT	Not published; estimated < 500 vpd (local cul-de-sac / loop street)
Speed limit	25 mph (residential default)

Cinchring Lane is a low-volume local residential street interior to the Scofield Subdivision. Under the Austin Strategic Mobility Plan (ASMP), streets not named in the Street Network Table default to Level 1. Level 1 streets typically have a 50-ft ROW with two travel lanes and no center turn lane. No ROW expansion or street widening is anticipated.

2. Nearby Major Roads

Street	ASMP Level	Functional Class	Lanes	Existing ROW	Future ROW	Est. AADT
Scofield Ridge Pkwy	Level 2	Minor collector	2-3	60 ft	66-70 ft	~3,000-5,000
Parmer Ln (FM 734)	Level 5	Principal arterial (TxDOT)	6 (divided)	120+ ft	150 ft (ASMP)	~45,000-55,000
MoPac (Loop 1)	Level 5 / Freeway	Freeway (TxDOT)	6-8 (divided + managed lanes)	Varies (200+ ft)	N/A (state facility)	~90,000-120,000

Parmer Lane (FM 734) is the primary east-west arterial serving the Scofield area. TxDOT and CAMPO are conducting the Parmer Lane Corridor Study (FM 734 from MoPac to RM 1431) to identify capacity and safety improvements. MoPac (Loop 1) runs roughly 1 mile west of the site and provides regional north-south freeway access.

3. ROW Dedication

Under Austin’s Transportation Criteria Manual (TCM) and ASMP, ROW dedication is required when the existing ROW is narrower than the ASMP future ROW standard. For Cinchring Lane (Level 1, 50-ft standard), the existing platted ROW in the Scofield Subdivision is expected to already meet the 50-ft standard. Therefore, **no additional ROW dedication is anticipated** for this project.

If any dedication delta were identified during site plan review, the city would require a dedication along the property frontage as a condition of the building permit or site plan approval. The City of Austin’s Residential Review Guidelines (rev. November 2025) govern ROW review for residential projects.

4. Traffic Impact Analysis (TIA)

Austin requires a TIA when a proposed development generates **2,000 or more net new vehicular trips per day**. The TIA Determination Worksheet must be submitted to the Transportation Development Services (TDS) Division.

Metric	Value
Existing use	Single-family detached (1 unit)
Proposed use	Duplex (2 units)
Net new units	+1 unit
ITE trip generation (Land Use 210/220)	~9.4 trips/day per dwelling unit
Net new daily trips	~9-10 trips/day
TIA threshold	2,000 trips/day

Conclusion: No TIA is required. The net new trip generation (~10 trips/day) is far below the 2,000-trip threshold. No TIA Determination Worksheet filing is necessary for a project of this scale.

5. Access Management -- Driveway Requirements

Austin’s TCM Section 7 (Driveways) governs driveway design and spacing. For a duplex on a Level 1 local street:

- **Maximum driveways:** Typically 1-2, depending on lot frontage.
- **Driveway width:** Residential driveway maximum 24 ft (two-way) per TCM.
- **Spacing:** Minimum 35 ft between driveways (edge to edge) if semicircular layout used.
- **Setback from intersection:** Minimum 30 ft from the nearest cross-street curb return.
- **Construction:** Driveway must be constructed within the street frontage of the subject property; no overlap onto adjacent property frontage without written approval.

A single shared driveway serving both duplex units is the most common configuration and satisfies all spacing requirements.

6. Transit Access

Bus Service (CapMetro)

Route	Name	Nearest Stop	Approx. Distance	Headway
392	Braker	Parmer Ln at McCallen Pass / Tech Ridge	~1.0-1.5 mi	30-60 min

243	Wells Branch	Howard Station / Tech Ridge	~1.5-2.0 mi	30-60 min
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The site is not directly served by a bus route on Cinchring Lane. The nearest CapMetro bus service operates along Parmer Lane and the Tech Ridge Park & Ride area, approximately 1.0-2.0 miles from the property. Service frequency is moderate (30-60 minute headways depending on time of day).

Project Connect Light Rail

The Project Connect Orange Line (light rail) is planned to extend north along the N. Lamar / I-35 corridor. Future stations are contemplated at Parmer Lane and Tech Ridge, but these are **not part of the initial investment phase**. They are identified as future-phase extensions, currently undergoing environmental clearance. No construction timeline has been set for these stations. The nearest planned initial-phase station (North Lamar Transit Center) is approximately 5-6 miles south of the site.

MetroRail (Red Line)

The existing CapMetro Red Line commuter rail has a station at Howard Station (Tech Ridge area), approximately 2.5 miles east of the site.

7. Bicycle and Pedestrian Infrastructure

Sidewalks

Austin’s Land Development Code and Residential Review Guidelines require sidewalks as part of residential development. For a duplex redevelopment on a local street:

- **Sidewalk requirement:** A minimum 5-ft sidewalk is typically required along the property frontage within the ROW.
- **Fee-in-lieu:** If physical constraints prevent sidewalk construction, a fee-in-lieu payment may be accepted per LDE Residential Review Guidelines.
- **Existing conditions:** Cinchring Lane in the Scofield Subdivision may have existing sidewalks on one or both sides from the original subdivision plat; the project must maintain or improve frontage sidewalk to current standards.

Bicycle Facilities

No dedicated bike lanes exist on Cinchring Lane. As a low-speed, low-volume Level 1 residential street, shared-lane (bicycle-with-traffic) operation is the applicable standard. No bike lane construction is required as part of this project.

The nearest designated bicycle infrastructure is along Parmer Lane and MoPac frontage roads, per the Austin Bicycle Plan and ASMP Active Transportation component.

8. Scenic Roadway Overlay

The Austin scenic roadway overlay applies to specific designated corridors including Loop 360, RM 2222 (west of MoPac), Barton Springs Road, Lake Austin Boulevard, and others. **Cinchring Lane is not a designated scenic roadway**. Neither Scofield Ridge Parkway nor Parmer Lane in this segment carries a scenic roadway overlay designation.

No scenic roadway overlay requirements apply to this project.

9. Summary of Key Findings

Item	Finding	Action Required
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TIA	Not required (~10 net new trips/day vs. 2,000 threshold)	None
ROW dedication	No delta expected (existing ROW meets Level 1 standard)	Confirm at plan review
Driveway permit	Required for new driveway construction	Submit driveway permit application
Sidewalk	May be required along frontage	Construct or pay fee-in-lieu
Transit	Limited; nearest bus ~1 mi on Parmer Ln	Informational only
Scenic overlay	Not applicable	None
Bike lanes	Not required on Level 1 local street	None

Sources:

- Austin Strategic Mobility Plan (ASMP) Street Network Table and Map
- Austin Transportation Criteria Manual (TCM), Sections 2, 7, and 10 (via Municode Library)
- City of Austin TIA Guidelines (June 2022) and TIA Determination Worksheet
- City of Austin LDE Residential Review Guidelines (rev. November 2025)
- CapMetro route schedules and system map (capmetro.org)
- TxDOT Parmer Lane (FM 734) Corridor Study
- Project Connect / Orange Line planning documents

Web Follow-ups: Utilities, Schools, Special Districts & Hazards

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 (Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision, Travis County) **Proposed Use:** Demolish existing SFR; build duplex (2 units, ground-up new construction) **Research Date:** 2026-06-03

1. Water -- Austin Water

Austin Water serves this address. A duplex requires a **Utility Tap Plan** prepared by a Texas-licensed PE and submitted to the Tap Plan Review team. Each unit must have a separate meter. No building permits are issued until all tap fees are paid.

Capital Recovery (Impact) Fees depend on when the lot was platted. Scofield was platted in the 1980s-90s, so the pre-2018 tier likely applies, but Austin Water determines the applicable tier. Current published rates (lots platted after Oct 1, 2023) are:

Component	Per Service Unit
Water	\$4,800
Wastewater	\$2,900
Combined	\$7,700

A duplex = 2 service units, so the combined capital recovery fees could be approximately **\$15,400** (2 x \$7,700) at the highest tier. Actual amount may be lower depending on plat date. Meter and inspection fees are additional.

Source: [Austin Water Rates and Fees](#) | [New Service Connections](#)

2. Wastewater -- Austin Water

Austin Water provides sanitary sewer service. An existing **concrete sanitary sewer vault** is noted on site. Each duplex unit requires a separate clean-out. The property owner is responsible for installing yard lines (pipes between the property line and the building).

A right-of-way permit from Austin Transportation and Public Works is required before installing service connections. The existing sewer vault should be evaluated during demolition planning -- it may need to be removed, capped, or re-used depending on Austin Water's determination.

Source: [New Service Connections](#) | [Construction Standards](#)

3. Electric -- Austin Energy

The property is within Austin Energy's service territory. For new duplex construction:

- File a **Building Service Planning Application (BSPA)** through Development Services.
- File a separate **Electric Service Planning Application (ESPA)** for each meter (i.e., one per unit).
- A **spot location** site visit is required to identify the point of service and verify clearances.
- A **Service Availability Letter** can be requested for financing.

Contact: 512-494-9400 or 3-1-1.

Source: [Austin Energy -- Apply for Electric Service](#) | [ESPA](#)

4. Gas -- Texas Gas Service

Texas Gas Service is the natural gas provider for the Austin/Travis County area. The 78727 zip code is within their service territory. Gas availability at this specific address should be confirmed by contacting Texas Gas Service directly.

Contact: texasgasservice.com | Office: 1301 S MoPac Expy, Suite 400, Austin, TX 78746

5. Telecom / Internet

Provider	Availability in 78727	Notes
Spectrum	~100% coverage in 78727	Cable; plans from ~\$30/mo
AT&T Fiber	Available in ~25% of area	Up to 5 Gbps; verify at address
Google Fiber	Limited Austin coverage	Primarily Central/East Austin; check address

Verify address-level availability at each provider's website.

Source: [Allconnect -- 78727 Providers](#) | [BroadbandNow -- Austin 78727](#)

6. School District -- Pflugerville ISD

This property is in the **Pflugerville Independent School District** (not Austin ISD or Round Rock ISD). Scofield Farms sits at the western edge of PISD boundaries.

Level	School	Niche Grade
Elementary	Parmer Lane Elementary	B
Middle	Westview Middle School	C+
High	Connally High School	A- (college prep)

Source: [Scofield Farms Neighborhood Guide](#) | [Scofield Farms General](#)

7. Special Districts

MUD / PID: No evidence that Scofield Farms is within a Municipal Utility District (MUD) or Public Improvement District (PID). The subdivision is served directly by City of Austin utilities (Austin Water, Austin Energy). The TCEQ Water Districts Map Viewer can be used to confirm: [TCEQ Map Viewer](#).

ESD: The property may be served by **Travis County Emergency Services District No. 4**, which covers neighborhoods in the Scofield area. Since the property is within Austin city limits, fire service is provided by the Austin Fire Department; the ESD designation relates to supplemental emergency services.

TIF: No Tax Increment Financing district was identified for this area.

Source: [Travis County ESDs](#)

8. Recent Council / Commission Actions

No pending zoning cases were identified for this specific address or the immediate Scofield area in the City of Austin zoning case database.

Relevant citywide action -- HOME Initiative: Austin's HOME (Home Options for Middle-income Empowerment) amendments, effective February 5, 2024, allow up to 3 dwelling units by right on SF-1, SF-2, and SF-3 lots. Phase 2 (citywide as of November 16, 2024) further reduced minimum lot sizes. A duplex

is permitted by right under HOME in SF-zoned lots without rezoning. However, **HOME does not override private deed restrictions or HOA covenants** (see Section 11 below).

Source: [HOME Amendments](#) | [Texas Tribune](#)

9. Soil Conditions

The 78727 area of north Austin lies in the **Blackland Prairie** ecological region, characterized by deep, dark, clay-rich soils (Vertisols). Likely soil series in this area include **Houston Black clay** and related series (Altoga, Branyon, Heiden).

Key characteristics:

- **Shrink-swell potential:** HIGH. These "cracking clays" expand when wet and contract when dry, forming deep cracks. This is the dominant foundation risk in Austin.
- **Foundation recommendation:** Engineered slab-on-grade with post-tensioned cables or drilled piers. A geotechnical report is strongly recommended before design.
- **Septic suitability:** Poor (high-clay, low-permeability), but not relevant here as city sewer is available.

A site-specific geotechnical investigation should be conducted prior to foundation design.

Source: [USDA Web Soil Survey](#) | [Travis County Soils](#)

10. Wildfire / Hazard Risk

Scofield Farms is a **suburban, fully developed neighborhood** with no significant wildland-urban interface (WUI) exposure. The area is flat, urbanized, and lacks the dense cedar/juniper vegetation that drives wildfire risk in western Travis County.

Austin's wildfire risk is concentrated in the Edwards Plateau / Hill Country areas (west and southwest Austin). North Austin neighborhoods like Scofield Farms are generally classified as **low wildfire risk**.

The Texas Wildfire Risk Assessment Portal (TxWRAP) can be used for site-specific confirmation: [TxWRAP Map](#)

Source: [City of Austin Wildfire](#) | [TxWRAP](#)

11. HOA -- Scofield Farms Residential Owners Association (ROA)

THIS IS A CRITICAL FEASIBILITY ISSUE FOR THE DUPLEX.

HOA: Scofield Residential Owners Association, Inc. **Management:** Inframark (formerly Certified Management of Austin) **Contact:** communitymanagement@inframark.com | 512-287-8000 **Dues:** Reported as under \$40/month (~\$480/year); includes pool access keycard. **Website:** scofieldfarms.org

Architectural Control Committee (ACC):

- 5-member committee reviews proposed additions and changes.
- ACC approval is required for exterior modifications; contact modifications@inframark.com.

Deed Restrictions -- Duplex Feasibility Risk: Scofield Farms has a Declaration of Covenants, Conditions and Deed Restrictions (with at least 8 amendments). The actual deed restriction documents are hosted on the HOA website but their full text was not publicly viewable during this research. Typical 1980s-90s subdivision CCRs in Texas **restrict lots to single-family residential use**, which would prohibit a duplex regardless of what city zoning (HOME initiative) allows.

Key legal principle: Under Texas law, city zoning is the floor and deed restrictions are the ceiling. The HOME initiative explicitly does not override private deed restrictions. If the Scofield Farms CCRs restrict the property to single-family use, a duplex cannot be built without either (a) obtaining a variance/waiver from the HOA, or (b) the HOA choosing not to enforce the restriction.

Action Required: Before proceeding with duplex design, the owner must obtain and review the Scofield Farms Declaration of Covenants, Conditions and Deed Restrictions (and all amendments) to determine whether multi-family or duplex use is prohibited. This document can be requested from Inframark or found in the Travis County deed records.

Source: [Scofield Farms HOA](#) | [HOA Rules & Regs Documents](#) | [Community Not Commodity -- HOA & HOME](#)

Summary of Key Findings

Topic	Finding	Risk/Action
Water	Austin Water; tap plan + impact fees ~\$15,400 for 2 units	Budget for fees
Wastewater	Austin Water sewer; existing vault on site	Coordinate with AW on vault disposition
Electric	Austin Energy; ESPA per unit	Standard process
Gas	Texas Gas Service; confirm at address	Verify availability
Telecom	Spectrum (best coverage), AT&T, Google Fiber (limited)	Check address
Schools	Pflugerville ISD (Parmer Lane / Westview / Connally)	Informational
Special Districts	No MUD/PID identified; within city limits	Low concern
Zoning/Council	HOME allows duplex by right in SF zones	Favorable
Soil	High shrink-swell clay; geotech report needed	Budget for geotech
Wildfire	Low risk (suburban, flat, no WUI)	Low concern
HOA	Scofield Farms ROA -- deed restrictions likely restrict to SFR	CRITICAL: Review CCRs before proceeding

Restrictive Covenants Analysis

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 (Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision) **Proposed Use:** Demolish existing SFR; construct duplex (2 units, ground-up) **Research Date:** 2026-06-03

1. HOA Identification

Field	Detail
HOA Name	Scofield Residential Owners Association, Inc.
Management Company	Inframark (formerly Certified Management of Austin)
Contact Email	communitymanagement@inframark.com
Contact Phone	512-287-8000
Modifications Email	modifications@inframark.com
Website	scofieldfarms.org
Dues	Approximately \$480/year (~\$40/month)
Community Size	Approximately 574 homes

2. Declaration of Covenants, Conditions & Restrictions (CC&Rs)

Status: FULL TEXT NOT OBTAINED — CRITICAL DATA GAP

The Scofield Farms subdivision is governed by a Declaration of Covenants, Conditions and Deed Restrictions with at least **8 recorded amendments**. These documents are referenced on the HOA website but the full text was not publicly accessible during this research. The documents are recorded in the Travis County deed records.

Key Reference Documents

Document	Recording Reference
Original Declaration	Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147, Travis County Deed Records
Amendments (1-8)	Referenced on HOA website; specific recording references not confirmed
Plat	Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265, Plat Records, Travis County

3. Likely Restrictions Based on Subdivision Character

Scofield Farms is a 1980s-1990s suburban single-family subdivision in north Austin. Based on the era of development and subdivision type, the CC&Rs are expected to contain the following provisions (typical for Texas residential subdivisions of this period):

3.1 Use Restrictions

Expected: Lots restricted to **single-family residential use only**. This is the standard restriction in Texas subdivision CC&Rs of this era and would prohibit duplex, two-family, or multi-family construction.

Legal significance: Under Texas law (Texas Property Code Chapter 202), deed restrictions are private covenants enforceable by the HOA and/or adjacent property owners through civil litigation. They operate independently of municipal zoning. The City of Austin’s HOME Initiative explicitly does **not** override private deed restrictions.

3.2 Architectural Control

Confirmed: The Scofield Farms ROA maintains a 5-member **Architectural Control Committee (ACC)** that reviews and approves exterior modifications. ACC approval is required before any exterior construction, remodeling, or alteration.

Implication for duplex: Even if the CC&Rs do not explicitly prohibit duplex use, the ACC review process would apply to any new construction, including design, materials, height, setbacks, and site layout.

3.3 Building Setbacks

Expected: The CC&Rs may establish building setbacks that differ from (and are potentially more restrictive than) both the base zoning setbacks and the HOME Phase 1 modified setbacks. The 25-foot building line shown on the plat is likely incorporated by reference into the CC&Rs.

3.4 Height and Massing

Expected: CC&Rs may impose height limits (typically 1 or 2 stories) and/or maximum building footprint restrictions that could be more restrictive than the SF-2 zoning standards.

3.5 Outbuildings and Accessory Structures

Expected: Restrictions on detached structures, carports, and accessory buildings that could affect duplex site planning.

4. Legal Framework: Deed Restrictions vs. Zoning

Texas Law

Principle	Detail
Private enforcement	CC&Rs are private contracts enforceable by the HOA or individual lot owners through civil courts, not through city code enforcement
City cannot override	The City of Austin cannot waive or override private deed restrictions through zoning changes, including HOME Initiative amendments
Statute of limitations	Under Texas Property Code § 202.003, restrictive covenants in subdivisions with a property owners’ association may be enforced indefinitely (no automatic expiration)
Amendment process	CC&Rs can typically be amended by a vote of the membership (usually requiring a supermajority, e.g., 67% or 75% of lot owners), or by petition under Texas Property Code Chapter 209

HOME Initiative and Deed Restrictions

The HOME Initiative Phase 1 (Ord. 20231207-001) amended Austin’s Land Development Code to permit duplexes by right on SF-2 lots. However:

- **HOME does not preempt private deed restrictions.** If the Scofield Farms CC&Rs restrict lots to single-family use, a duplex remains prohibited as a matter of private covenant regardless of city zoning.

- The city will issue a building permit for a duplex if the project meets zoning and code requirements — but the permit does not immunize the owner from HOA enforcement action.
- The HOA or individual lot owners could seek injunctive relief (a court order to stop or reverse construction) if the project violates the CC&Rs.

5. Risk Assessment

Risk Factor	Severity	Detail
Single-family use restriction in CC&Rs	CRITICAL	If present (highly likely), prohibits duplex construction regardless of zoning
ACC approval required	HIGH	Even if duplex use is permitted, ACC must approve design; denial would block construction
HOA enforcement history	UNKNOWN	No data on whether the HOA has enforced use restrictions against similar projects
CC&R amendment feasibility	LOW PROBABILITY	Amending CC&Rs to permit duplex use would require supermajority vote of ~574 homeowners

6. Required Actions Before Proceeding

1. **Obtain and review the full Declaration of CC&Rs** (Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147) and all 8 amendments from either:
 - Inframark (communitymanagement@inframark.com)
 - Travis County Clerk's office (online or in-person)
 - Title company providing the title commitment
2. **Identify the specific use restriction language** — determine whether the CC&Rs restrict lots to "single-family residential use," "single-family dwellings," or similar limiting language. Note any exceptions, variance provisions, or amendment thresholds.
3. **Consult with a Texas real estate attorney** to evaluate:
 - Whether the specific CC&R language prohibits a duplex
 - Whether any defenses (laches, waiver, changed conditions) could apply
 - Whether an HOA variance or amendment is feasible
 - The risk of injunctive relief if construction proceeds without HOA approval
4. **Contact the HOA Board** (via Inframark) to discuss the proposed project informally before committing to design or permit applications.

7. Summary

The Scofield Farms HOA deed restrictions represent the single most significant feasibility risk for this duplex project. While Austin's HOME Phase 1 permits a duplex by right on this SF-2 lot as a matter of zoning, private deed restrictions almost certainly restrict the property to single-family residential use. Until the full CC&Rs are reviewed and a legal strategy is developed, the duplex project should be considered **at risk of HOA enforcement action.**

This is not a zoning constraint — it is a private covenant constraint that operates outside the city's regulatory framework.

Research date: June 3, 2026. CC&R full text was not obtained during this research session. This analysis is based on HOA website information, subdivision characteristics, and standard Texas CC&R provisions for 1980s-1990s residential subdivisions.

Part II — Discipline Assessments

Zoning & Land Use Findings -- 12713 Cinchring Ln

Summary

- **Base district:** SF-2 (Single-Family Residential -- Standard Lot). No combining districts, overlays, or suffixes. Zoning string: SF-2.
- **Overlays / combining districts:** None. No NCCD, CO, NP, historic, ETOD, DB90, VMU, WO, CVC, AO, or HCRC overlay applies. Confirmed via GIS research and absence from overlay layer inventories.
- **Proposed use compatibility:** Duplex (two-unit residential) is **permitted by right** under HOME Phase 1 (Ord. 20231207-001, eff. Feb 5, 2024) on SF-2 lots. No rezoning, conditional use permit, or Board of Adjustment action required.
- **Procedural path:** Residential building permit only. The project is exempt from site plan requirements (fewer than 4 units). Demolition permit required for the existing house (separate administrative process).
- **Critical risk:** Scofield Farms HOA CC&Rs almost certainly restrict the lot to single-family residential use. HOME Phase 1 does not override private deed restrictions. This is a non-zoning constraint that could block the project regardless of code compliance.

Zoning Capacity Table

Standard	Code Limit (SF-2)	Modifier	Effective Limit	Proposed	Status
Use	SF, duplex, two-unit, three-unit (HOME Phase 1)	None	Duplex permitted by right	Duplex (2 units)	Pass
Height	35 ft (LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D))	None	35 ft	TBD (no concept plan)	Data-gap
FAR	0.40:1 (LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D))	None	0.40:1 = ~3,136 sf GFA on 7,840 sf lot	TBD	Data-gap
Building coverage	40% (LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D))	None	40% = ~3,136 sf footprint	TBD	Data-gap
Impervious cover	45% (- zoning); Walnut Creek suburban watershed	More restrictive controls; 45% zoning limit likely governs	45% = ~3,528 sf	TBD	Data-gap
Parking	None (eliminated Nov 13, 2023, Ord. 20231102-028)	No PUD exhibit; no UNO	0 spaces required	TBD	Pass
Min lot area	5,750 sf (SF-2 / HOME duplex)	None	5,750 sf	~7,840 sf	Pass
Min lot width	50 ft (duplex standard)	None	50 ft	TBD -- verify from plat	Data-gap
Front setback	15 ft (HOME Phase 1 for duplex/two-unit)	25 ft platted building line controls (more restrictive)	25 ft	TBD	Data-gap

Interior side setback	5 ft (HOME Phase 1)	None	5 ft	TBD	Data-gap
Street side setback	10 ft (HOME Phase 1)	N/A (interior lot)	10 ft (if applicable)	TBD	Data-gap
Rear setback	5 ft (HOME Phase 1, reduced from 10 ft)	Easements may further restrict	5 ft (excl. easements)	TBD	Data-gap

Practical envelope on ~7,840 sf lot:

- Maximum building footprint (40%): ~3,136 sf
- Maximum impervious cover (45%): ~3,528 sf
- Maximum gross floor area (0.40:1 FAR): ~3,136 sf
- Available building depth (front-to-rear): lot depth minus 25 ft (front building line) minus 5 ft (rear setback) minus any rear easement encumbrance

Findings

F-1: Duplex Permitted by Right Under HOME Phase 1

- **Severity:** Opportunity
- **Citation:** Ord. 20231207-001 (HOME Phase 1), eff. Feb 5, 2024; LDC Sec. 25-2-492 as amended
- **Finding:** HOME Phase 1 amended the SF-2 use table to permit duplex, two-unit, and three-unit residential uses by right on all SF-1, SF-2, and SF-3 lots citywide. The lot at ~7,840 sf exceeds the 5,750 sf minimum. No rezoning, conditional use permit, variance, or density bonus program enrollment is required.
- **Implication:** The developer has a clear by-right entitlement path. No discretionary approval body (Planning Commission, Land Use Commission, Board of Adjustment, City Council) is involved in the use determination.
- **Recommended next step:** Proceed with residential building permit application. No zoning action needed.

F-2: 25-Foot Platted Building Line Controls Front Setback

- **Severity:** Moderate
- **Citation:** Plat of Scofield Subdivision, Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265, Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147; LDC Sec. 25-2-492(B) (more restrictive standard governs)
- **Finding:** HOME Phase 1 reduces the zoning front setback to 15 ft for duplex/two-unit uses. However, the recorded plat for Scofield Subdivision establishes a 25-foot building line on the front of Lot 12. Under Austin practice, platted building lines are enforceable through the permitting process, and the more restrictive requirement controls. The 25 ft front building line governs over the 15 ft HOME setback, reducing the buildable depth by 10 feet compared to what HOME would otherwise allow.
- **Implication:** The building envelope loses approximately 10 ft of depth at the front. On a lot of this size, this is a material constraint on total buildable area, particularly given the tight FAR cap (0.40:1). Two-story massing must fit within the reduced depth.
- **Recommended next step:** (1) Confirm with DSD whether the platted building line is enforced at building permit review or treated as a private covenant only. (2) If enforced, evaluate whether a replat to reduce the building line is feasible and cost-justified. (3) Design the duplex assuming 25 ft front setback unless a replat is pursued.

F-3: FAR Cap Constrains Total Floor Area

- **Severity:** Moderate
- **Citation:** LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D) (SF-2: 0.40:1 FAR)
- **Finding:** The 0.40:1 FAR limit yields a maximum gross floor area of approximately 3,136 sf on the ~7,840 sf lot. For a duplex, this translates to roughly 1,568 sf per unit. This is a meaningful constraint for a two-story duplex targeting market-rate finishes in a suburban location where competing product (single-family homes in Scofield) averages 1,800-2,400 sf. GFA under LDC Sec. 25-1-21(47) includes all enclosed floor area except parking, driveways, enclosed loading berths, and atria airspace.
- **Implication:** Unit sizes will be capped around 1,500 sf each. Garages and covered parking are excluded from GFA and do not count against FAR, which provides some design flexibility. The developer should verify whether HOME Phase 1 applies the alternative FAR formula (55% of lot area or 3,200 sf, whichever is greater, for two-unit uses) -- the programs research references this alternative, which would yield ~4,312 sf (55% x 7,840) or 3,200 sf, potentially more generous than the 0.40:1 base.
- **Recommended next step:** Confirm the applicable FAR standard with DSD -- specifically whether HOME Phase 1 substitutes the "55% or 3,200 sf" formula for the base 0.40:1 ratio for two-unit uses. Design GFA accordingly.

F-4: No Parking Minimums

- **Severity:** Opportunity
- **Citation:** Ord. 20231102-028 (eff. Nov 13, 2023); LDC Sec. 25-6-471(A)
- **Finding:** Austin eliminated all minimum off-street parking requirements citywide in November 2023. No minimum spaces are required for a duplex. ADA accessible spaces are required only if a common parking facility is provided (not applicable to a typical duplex with individual driveways). No PUD parking exhibit or UNO maximum applies.
- **Implication:** Parking is a free design variable. The developer can provide as much or as little as the market demands. In suburban north Austin, market expectations typically call for 2 spaces per unit (4 total), but no code minimum compels this.
- **Recommended next step:** Size parking to market demand. A single shared driveway or two individual driveways serving both units is the typical configuration.

F-5: No Overlays, Combining Districts, or Compatibility Triggers

- **Severity:** Note
- **Citation:** Austin GIS overlay layers (CVC, Capitol Dominance, HCRC, AO, WO, NCCD, ETOD, DB90, VMU, NP, CO, historic); LDC Sec. 25-2-1051 (Compatibility Standards applicability)
- **Finding:** No overlay or combining district applies to this parcel. The property is not within any NCCD, CO, NP, historic district, TOD regulating plan, ETOD subdistrict, CVC, Capitol Dominance, HCRC, AO, or WO boundary. Article 10 Compatibility Standards (post-July 2024) do not apply because the site is zoned SF-2 (less restrictive than MF-4 threshold for applicability) and the proposed use is duplex (exempt per Sec. 25-2-1052).
- **Implication:** The dimensional envelope is governed solely by the SF-2 base district standards as modified by HOME Phase 1. No overlay-driven height caps, buffer requirements, design review boards, or additional setbacks apply.
- **Recommended next step:** None required. This is a clean regulatory position.

F-6: Site Plan Exempt -- Building Permit Only

- **Severity:** Opportunity
- **Citation:** LDC Sec. 25-5 (site plan requirements); HOME Phase 1 residential infill provisions

- **Finding:** Residential uses of four or fewer units on an existing platted lot are exempt from site plan requirements. The duplex proceeds via residential building permit application only. No Consolidated Site Plan, Site Plan Lite, or F1/F2 staged plan is required. The lot also qualifies for the Site Plan Lite Phase 2 drainage review exemption (lots of 11,500 sf or less), eliminating the need for an engineered drainage study or on-site detention.
- **Implication:** The permitting path is streamlined -- no site plan review, no Watershed Protection Department drainage plan review, no site plan fees. Timeline from application to permit issuance is typically 4-8 weeks for residential plan review (subject to DSD workload).
- **Recommended next step:** Submit residential building permit application through Austin DSD. Include demolition permit application for the existing house (separate process, 2-4 weeks).

F-7: HOA CC&Rs -- Critical Non-Zoning Feasibility Risk

- **Severity:** Significant
- **Citation:** Declaration of Covenants, Conditions and Deed Restrictions, Scofield Subdivision, Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147, Travis County Deed Records (plus 8 recorded amendments)
- **Finding:** Scofield Farms is governed by an HOA (Scofield Residential Owners Association, managed by Inframark) with recorded CC&Rs and an active Architectural Control Committee. The full CC&R text was not obtained during this research effort. Based on subdivision era (1990s) and character, the CC&Rs almost certainly restrict lots to single-family residential use. HOME Phase 1 does not preempt private deed restrictions under Texas law (Texas Property Code Ch. 202). The city will issue a building permit for a code-compliant duplex, but the permit does not immunize the owner from HOA enforcement. The HOA or individual lot owners could seek injunctive relief in court to block or reverse construction.
- **Implication:** This is the single largest feasibility risk for the project. Even with a valid building permit, the developer faces potential litigation, injunction, and forced reversal if the CC&Rs prohibit duplex use. CC&R amendment requires a supermajority vote of ~574 homeowners, which is practically infeasible for a single-lot project.
- **Recommended next step:** (1) Obtain the full Declaration of CC&Rs and all 8 amendments from Inframark or Travis County Clerk. (2) Have a Texas real estate attorney review the specific use-restriction language. (3) Assess available defenses (laches, waiver, changed conditions). (4) Contact the HOA Board informally before committing to design. (5) Do not proceed to permit application until the CC&R risk is resolved or accepted.

F-8: Walnut Creek Suburban Watershed -- 45% Impervious Cover

- **Severity:** Note
- **Citation:** LDC Ch. 25-8, Sec. 25-8-392 (Suburban Watershed Uplands Zone); LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D) (SF-2 IC: 45%)
- **Finding:** The property is in the Walnut Creek watershed, classified as a suburban watershed under LDC Ch. 25-8. The SF-2 zoning impervious cover limit of 45% is the likely controlling standard (the watershed limit for residential in suburban uplands is 45-50%). The more restrictive of zoning or watershed limits applies. At 45%, maximum IC is approximately 3,528 sf on the ~7,840 sf lot. IC includes all building footprint, driveways, sidewalks, patios, and other impervious surfaces.
- **Implication:** After accounting for the building footprint (~3,136 sf at 40% coverage), approximately 392 sf of additional impervious surface is available for driveway, walkways, and patios. This is tight. Permeable paving for driveways or walkways may be needed to stay within the IC limit while providing adequate parking and circulation.
- **Recommended next step:** Coordinate site layout to fit within the 45% IC cap. Consider permeable driveway materials. The 2-ft projection exemption (ECM Sec. 1.8.1(C)) may apply to eaves at the residential building permit level but should not be relied upon without confirming current DSD practice.

NOETIC

F-9: Lot Width Verification Needed

- **Severity:** Data-gap
- **Citation:** LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D) (SF-2: 50 ft minimum lot width for duplex)
- **Finding:** HOME Phase 1 requires a minimum lot width of 50 ft for duplex use. The lot area (~7,840 sf) is adequate, but the actual lot width has not been confirmed from the plat. If the lot is narrower than 50 ft, the duplex use would not qualify under HOME standards without a variance.
- **Implication:** If the lot width is below 50 ft, a Board of Adjustment variance would be required, adding 3-6 months and introducing discretionary risk.
- **Recommended next step:** Obtain the Scofield Subdivision plat (Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265) from Travis County and confirm the lot width of Lot 12, Block M.

F-10: HOME Phase 1 FAR Formula May Be More Generous

- **Severity:** Data-gap
- **Citation:** Ord. 20231207-001 (HOME Phase 1); programs research referencing "55% or 3,200 sf, whichever is greater" for two-unit uses
- **Finding:** Research references a HOME Phase 1 FAR standard of "55% of lot area or 3,200 sf, whichever is greater" for two-unit uses, which would yield ~4,312 sf (55% x 7,840) rather than ~3,136 sf (0.40:1). This discrepancy between the base SF-2 FAR (0.40:1) and the HOME-amended standard has not been definitively resolved. The programs analysis also references a 30 ft / 2-story height limit under HOME, versus the 35 ft base SF-2 limit.
- **Implication:** If the 55% / 3,200 sf formula applies, the duplex can be approximately 1,176 sf larger in total GFA (~2,156 sf per unit instead of ~1,568 sf). This materially changes the project's market viability and design. The height limit question (30 ft vs. 35 ft) must also be resolved.
- **Recommended next step:** Confirm with DSD the exact FAR and height standards that apply to a two-unit development on an SF-2 lot under HOME Phase 1. Request written confirmation or cite the specific code section.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Lot width:** Confirm from the recorded plat (Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265) that Lot 12, Block M has a minimum width of 50 ft at the front building line. If narrower, a BOA variance is required.
2. **HOME Phase 1 FAR formula:** Confirm whether the applicable FAR for a two-unit use on SF-2 is the base 0.40:1 ratio (~3,136 sf) or the HOME-amended "55% of lot area or 3,200 sf, whichever is greater" (~4,312 sf). This is a ~1,176 sf difference in allowable GFA.
3. **HOME Phase 1 height limit:** Confirm whether the duplex is subject to 35 ft (base SF-2) or 30 ft / 2 stories (HOME Phase 1 modified standard). Research sources conflict on this point.
4. **Platted building line enforceability:** Confirm with DSD whether the 25 ft platted building line (Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147) is enforced through the building permit process or is treated as a private covenant enforceable only by adjacent owners. If enforced, evaluate replat feasibility to reduce to 15 ft.
5. **CC&R review:** Obtain and review the full Scofield Farms Declaration of CC&Rs (Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147) and all 8 amendments. Identify the specific single-family use restriction language and assess legal risk of proceeding with a duplex. This is the gating item for project feasibility.
6. **Impervious cover budget:** With 40% building coverage and 45% IC, only ~392 sf of non-building impervious surface is available for driveway, walkways, and patios. Confirm whether this is sufficient for the proposed site layout. Evaluate permeable paving options.
7. **5-ft PUE location:** Confirm from the plat where the 5-ft Public Utility Easement runs (front, side, or both). Structures and permanent improvements are prohibited within the PUE, which may further constrain the buildable area.

NOETIC

8. **Rear easement encumbrance:** Confirm whether the declarant's reserved 10-ft utility easement (Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147) has been exercised along the rear lot line. If so, the effective rear setback increases from 5 ft to 15 ft.
9. **Tree survey:** Determine whether any protected (19"+) or heritage (24"+) trees exist on the lot. Removal requires mitigation and may constrain building placement.
10. **Asbestos survey:** The existing house was built in 1993. Under TCEQ Asbestos NESHAP regulations, an asbestos survey is required before demolition of structures built before 2000. Coordinate survey before demolition permit application.

Site Plan & Form Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Zoning:** SF-2 (Single-Family Residential — Standard Lot) **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR (1993); build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot area:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres) **Date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **The duplex is exempt from site plan under LDC Chapter 25-5.** Residential uses of four or fewer units do not trigger site plan review. The project proceeds via residential building permit only — no administrative site plan, no Site Plan Lite, no commission review.
- **No rezoning, conditional use permit, or Board of Adjustment action is required.** HOME Phase 1 permits a duplex by right on SF-2 lots. The procedural path is a straightforward residential building permit through Austin DSD.
- **Subchapter E (Design Standards and Mixed Use) does not apply.** Subchapter E is triggered only when a project requires a site plan under Chapter 25-5. Because the duplex is site-plan-exempt, no build-to, glazing, entrance orientation, articulation, or sidewalk-zone standards under Subchapter E attach.
- **McMansion / Subchapter F standards are superseded by HOME Phase 1 for two-unit development.** HOME Phase 1 incorporated the favorable Subchapter F setback reductions (15 ft front, 5 ft rear) and eliminated sidewall articulation and tent requirements for duplex/two-unit uses on SF lots.
- **Demolition of the 1993 house requires a separate demolition permit and an asbestos survey.** Pre-2000 construction triggers TCEQ Asbestos NESHAP survey requirements before any demolition work begins.

Findings

1. Site Plan Exemption

Field	Detail
Severity	opportunity
Citation	LDC Chapter 25-5 (site plan exemptions); LDC § 25-5-1 et seq.
Finding	A duplex (2 units) on an existing platted lot is exempt from site plan requirements under Austin LDC. The Chapter 25-5 exemption applies to residential uses of four or fewer units. No administrative site plan, Site Plan Lite, or commission site plan is required.
Implication	This eliminates 6-9 months of site plan review timeline and associated engineering costs. The project proceeds directly to residential building permit, with an expected review timeline of 4-8 weeks. No Subchapter E compliance is triggered. No pre-application conference is needed.
Recommended next step	Confirm exemption at DSD intake. File residential building permit application directly.

2. Procedural Path — Residential Building Permit Only

Field	Detail
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Severity	note
Citation	HOME Phase 1 (Ord. 20231207-001, effective Feb 5, 2024); LDC § 25-2-492
Finding	HOME Phase 1 permits a duplex by right on SF-2 lots with no rezoning, no conditional use permit, and no Board of Adjustment variance. The lot at ~7,840 sq ft exceeds the 5,750 sq ft minimum lot area. The project requires only a residential building permit reviewed by DSD for compliance with LDC dimensional standards and IRC/IBC building codes.
Implication	The entitlement path is the simplest available under Austin's LDC. No public hearing, no discretionary approval, no neighborhood notification under zoning review. The only discretionary review risk is the HOA Architectural Control Committee (private covenant, outside city jurisdiction).
Recommended next step	Prepare building plans per HOME Phase 1 dimensional standards (40% building coverage, 0.40:1 FAR, 35 ft height, 45% IC) and submit to DSD residential plan review.

3. Subchapter E Does Not Apply

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC Subchapter E, § 1.2 (Applicability); LDC Chapter 25-5
Finding	Subchapter E applies only when a project requires a site plan under Chapter 25-5 (§ 1.2.1). Because this duplex is site-plan-exempt, Subchapter E design standards — including build-to percentages, ground-floor glazing minimums, entrance orientation requirements, sidewalk zone dimensions, parking placement rules, and articulation standards — do not apply to this project.
Implication	The developer has full design flexibility on facade treatment, entrance placement, glazing, and building orientation. No build-to percentage, no principal-street glazing minimum, no supplemental zone requirement. This substantially simplifies design and reduces facade cost.
Recommended next step	No action required. Do not load Subchapter E standards onto permit drawings.

4. McMansion / Subchapter F — Superseded by HOME Phase 1

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	HOME Phase 1 (Ord. 20231207-001); LDC Subchapter F (Residential Design and Compatibility Standards)

Finding	HOME Phase 1 incorporated Subchapter F's favorable setback reductions for two-unit and three-unit uses on SF lots (front setback reduced from 25 ft to 15 ft; rear from 10 ft to 5 ft). HOME also eliminated the McMansion sidewall articulation requirement and the tent/envelope requirement for duplex projects. The simplified design standards under HOME govern instead of the full Subchapter F framework.
Implication	The designer does not need to comply with the McMansion tent envelope, sidewall articulation, or street-facing garage limitations that apply to single-family construction in SF-2. However, FAR (0.40:1) and building coverage (40%) still apply and are the primary massing constraints on this lot.
Recommended next step	Design to HOME Phase 1 dimensional standards. Note the 25 ft platted building line (see Finding 6) may override the 15 ft HOME front setback.

5. Cinchring Lane — Level 1 Local Street, No Frontage Requirements

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	Austin Strategic Mobility Plan (ASMP) Street Network Table; LDC Subchapter E § 2.1 (principal street hierarchy)
Finding	Cinchring Lane is a Level 1 local residential street under the ASMP (50 ft ROW, 2 lanes, ~500 vpd, 25 mph). It is not a Core Transit Corridor (CTC), Urban Roadway, or Suburban Roadway under Subchapter E's principal street hierarchy. Even if Subchapter E applied (which it does not), a Level 1 local street would impose no build-to percentage, no glazing minimum, no entrance orientation mandate, and no parking placement restriction.
Implication	No frontage-driven form requirements from any source. No ROW dedication is anticipated (existing ROW meets Level 1 standard). No scenic roadway overlay applies.
Recommended next step	None required.

6. Platted 25-Foot Building Line — May Override HOME Front Setback

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	Plat, Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147, Travis County; HOME Phase 1 (15 ft front setback for duplex)
Finding	The recorded plat shows a 25-foot building line on the front of Lot 12. HOME Phase 1 reduces the zoning front setback to 15 ft for duplex uses. However, the platted building line is a recorded encumbrance. Under Austin practice, the more restrictive requirement controls — meaning the 25 ft platted building line likely governs over the 15 ft zoning setback at the permitting counter.

Implication	If the 25 ft building line is enforced through DSD plan review, the buildable depth is reduced by 10 ft compared to the HOME setback. On a lot of this size, that is a meaningful reduction in buildable area. To use the 15 ft setback, the owner would need to replat or amend the plat — which triggers subdivision review and adds timeline and cost.
Recommended next step	Confirm with DSD whether the platted building line is enforced at building permit review or treated as a private covenant only. If enforced, design to the 25 ft front setback. If a replat is desired, budget 3-6 months and engage a surveyor.

7. Demolition Permit and Asbestos Survey

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	TCEQ 30 TAC Chapter 113, Subchapter B (Asbestos NESHAP); Austin DSD demolition permit process
Finding	The existing house was built in 1993 — pre-2000 construction that may contain asbestos-containing materials (ACM) in roofing, siding, joint compound, floor tile, pipe insulation, or vermiculite attic insulation. TCEQ Asbestos NESHAP regulations require a thorough asbestos inspection by a licensed Texas asbestos inspector before any demolition. If ACM is found, abatement must be performed by a licensed contractor with proper notification to TCEQ before demolition proceeds. A separate demolition permit from Austin DSD is required; typical turnaround is 2-4 weeks.
Implication	The asbestos survey must be completed before demolition permit issuance. If ACM is found, abatement adds cost (\$3,000-\$15,000 depending on extent) and 2-4 weeks to the pre-construction timeline. Failure to survey before demolition is a TCEQ violation with significant penalties. Lead-based paint (LBP) is also a concern for pre-1978 construction but is less likely in a 1993 house (post-ban).
Recommended next step	Engage a licensed Texas asbestos inspector to perform a pre-demolition survey. Budget for potential ACM abatement. File demolition permit with DSD after survey is complete.

8. Building Separation — IRC Fire Separation, No Zoning Minimum

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	HOME Phase 1 dimensional standards; IRC R302.1 (exterior walls — fire separation distance)

NOETIC

Finding	HOME Phase 1 eliminated any zoning-based minimum building separation requirement for duplex units. The only separation requirement is the IRC fire-separation-distance standard: if the exterior wall is less than 3 feet from the lot line or from another building on the same lot, fire-resistance-rated construction is required per IRC R302.1 (1-hour fire-resistive construction, no openings). For a duplex with attached units sharing a common wall, the shared wall must be a 1-hour fire-rated assembly per IRC R302. For detached duplex units, fire separation distance governs openings and fire-resistance rating of exterior walls.
Implication	The developer has flexibility to build attached (side-by-side or stacked) or detached units. Attached construction with a 1-hour rated party wall is the most space-efficient configuration on a 7,840 sq ft lot. If detached, wall openings and projections near the property line or the other unit are restricted by IRC fire separation distance requirements.
Recommended next step	Coordinate with the architect and building code consultant on the fire separation assembly for the chosen configuration (attached vs. detached).

9. Drainage Review Exemption

Field	Detail
Severity	opportunity
Citation	Site Plan Lite Phase 2 drainage reforms (adopted Mar 6, 2025); LDC residential infill provisions
Finding	Under the Site Plan Lite Phase 2 drainage reforms, lots of 11,500 sq ft or less do not require drainage review. This lot at ~7,840 sq ft qualifies for the exemption. No engineered drainage study, no on-site detention pond, and no formal drainage plan submission is required, provided the site drains to the street or existing drainage infrastructure.
Implication	This eliminates the cost of an engineered drainage study (typically \$5,000-\$15,000) and the space burden of an on-site detention facility. The lot drains to the existing Scofield subdivision storm drainage system.
Recommended next step	Confirm drainage exemption eligibility at DSD intake. Ensure site grading directs runoff to the street or existing drainage system.

10. No Overlay-Driven Design Review

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC Chapter 25-2 (overlay districts); Austin GIS

NOETIC

Finding	The property is not within any overlay or combining district that would impose additional design review: no NCCD, no NP combining district, no Waterfront Overlay, no UNO, no Downtown Creeks, no Waller Creek District, no Historic District, no scenic roadway overlay, no ETOD overlay. No DDBP, VMU, or DB90 combining district applies. The property is not within any adopted regulating plan area (NBG, ERC, Plaza Saltillo, East MLK, Lamar/Justin Lane, Airport Boulevard, Downtown Austin Plan).
Implication	No additional design review gates, no advisory board reviews, no design commission hearings. The project is subject only to base SF-2 zoning standards as modified by HOME Phase 1 and applicable building codes.
Recommended next step	None required.

11. HOA Architectural Control Committee — Private Covenant Risk

Field	Detail
Severity	significant
Citation	Scofield Farms Declaration of CC&Rs, Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147, Travis County; Texas Property Code Chapter 202
Finding	The Scofield Farms ROA maintains an Architectural Control Committee (ACC) that reviews and must approve all exterior construction. The CC&Rs almost certainly restrict lots to single-family residential use — standard for 1980s-90s Texas subdivision declarations. HOME Phase 1 does not override private deed restrictions. If the CC&Rs prohibit duplex use, the HOA or individual lot owners could seek injunctive relief to block construction, even after a city building permit is issued. The full CC&R text has not been obtained — this remains a critical data gap.
Implication	This is outside the city's site-plan and building-permit framework, but it is the single largest feasibility risk for the project. A building permit does not immunize the owner from HOA enforcement. If the CC&Rs restrict to single-family use, the developer faces litigation risk or must obtain a CC&R amendment (requiring supermajority vote of ~574 homeowners) or HOA waiver.
Recommended next step	Obtain and review the full Declaration of CC&Rs and all 8 amendments from the Travis County Clerk or Inframark. Engage a Texas real estate attorney to evaluate the specific use-restriction language and enforcement risk before committing to design.

12. No Concept Plan Provided

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	N/A

NOETIC

Finding	No concept plan, site plan, or preliminary building design was provided for review. Specific building footprint, unit configuration (attached vs. detached, side-by-side vs. stacked), entrance placement, driveway location, and massing cannot be evaluated against the dimensional envelope.
Implication	The findings above address regulatory applicability and procedural path but cannot assess whether the proposed building fits within the 40% building coverage / 0.40:1 FAR / 45% IC envelope, or whether the 25 ft platted building line creates a design constraint for the intended program.
Recommended next step	Prepare a preliminary site plan showing building footprint, setbacks (using 25 ft front until platted building line is resolved), driveway, and impervious cover calculation. Verify that the duplex program fits within the FAR and coverage limits.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Platted building line enforcement:** Does Austin DSD enforce the 25 ft platted building line at residential building permit review, or is it treated as a private covenant enforceable only by neighbors/HOA? This determines whether the effective front setback is 15 ft (HOME) or 25 ft (plat).
2. **Lot width:** Does the lot meet the 50 ft minimum lot width required for duplex use under HOME Phase 1? The plat (Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265) should be reviewed to confirm lot dimensions.
3. **Asbestos survey results:** Has an asbestos inspection been performed on the 1993 house? If ACM is identified, what is the estimated abatement scope and cost?
4. **Unit configuration:** Are the two duplex units planned as attached (common party wall) or detached? This drives the IRC fire separation assembly requirements and affects building coverage efficiency.
5. **FAR feasibility:** At 0.40:1 FAR on ~7,840 sq ft, the maximum gross floor area is ~3,136 sq ft for both units combined. Does the intended unit program (number of bedrooms, unit sizes) fit within this limit? If a two-story design is contemplated, the 40% building coverage still caps the footprint at ~3,136 sq ft, but FAR governs total floor area across both stories.
6. **5-ft PUE location:** Where does the 5-foot public utility easement run on this lot (front, side, or both)? Structures and permanent improvements are prohibited within the PUE, which further constrains the buildable area.
7. **Existing sanitary sewer vault:** What is the disposition plan for the concrete sanitary sewer vault identified on site? Will it be removed, capped, or re-used? Coordinate with Austin Water.
8. **Tree survey:** Are there any protected trees (8 in. diameter or greater) or heritage trees (19 in. or greater) on the lot that would require preservation or mitigation?

Stormwater & Drainage Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot area:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Watershed:** Walnut Creek — Suburban Watershed classification **Floodplain:** Zone X (not in 100-year or 500-year floodplain) **EARZ:** Not in Edwards Aquifer Recharge Zone or Contributing Zone **Date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **Site Plan Lite drainage reforms exempt this lot from engineered drainage review and on-site detention.** At ~7,840 sq ft the lot is well under the 11,500 sq ft threshold; no drainage study, detention pond, or formal drainage plan is required, saving significant cost and schedule.
- **Impervious cover is capped at 45% (~3,528 sq ft) by the controlling SF-2 zoning limit**, which aligns with the Walnut Creek Suburban Watershed IC framework. The building footprint (40% / ~3,136 sq ft) plus driveways, sidewalks, and patios must stay within this envelope.
- **Water quality controls are likely satisfied by the existing Scofield subdivision regional facilities**, but this must be confirmed with the Watershed Protection Department since demolition-and-rebuild constitutes redevelopment subject to current WQ standards.
- **RSMP fee-in-lieu is a fallback option if detention is ever triggered**, but the Site Plan Lite exemption likely makes it unnecessary for this project. Eligibility in Walnut Creek watershed should be verified regardless.
- **No floodplain, EARZ, CEF, or erosion hazard zone constraints apply.** The site is in FEMA Zone X on upland terrain with no waterway within 100 ft, eliminating an entire class of drainage complications.

Findings

1. Site Plan Lite Drainage Exemption

Field	Detail
Severity	opportunity
Citation	Site Plan Lite Phase 2 (Ordinance adopted Mar 6, 2025, applications accepted Jun 16, 2025); LDC residential infill provisions
Finding	The Site Plan Lite drainage reforms exempt lots of 11,500 sq ft or less from drainage review. Lots up to 1 acre draining to an existing street or drainage system do not require on-site detention or an engineered drainage plan. This lot at ~7,840 sq ft qualifies on both counts.
Implication	The developer avoids the cost of an engineered drainage study, detention facility design, and associated review cycles. This removes what would otherwise be a \$15,000-\$40,000 engineering expense and 2-4 months of review time for a project of this scale.
Recommended next step	Confirm the lot drains to the existing street/storm system (expected for a platted Scofield lot on a local street). Verify with DSD that the exemption applies to demo-and-rebuild redevelopment, not just new construction on vacant lots.

2. Impervious Cover Limit — 45%

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	LDC Sec. 25-2-492(D) (SF-2 site development regulations); LDC Sec. 25-8-392 (Suburban Watershed uplands IC); HOME Phase 1 Ordinance 20231207-001
Finding	The SF-2 zoning impervious cover limit is 45%, yielding a maximum of ~3,528 sq ft of IC on this ~7,840 sq ft lot. The Walnut Creek Suburban Watershed IC limit for residential use is in the 45-50% range; the more restrictive of zoning or watershed controls. At 45%, the zoning limit is the binding constraint. Building coverage is separately capped at 40% (~3,136 sq ft).
Implication	After accounting for the building footprint (~3,136 sq ft maximum), only ~392 sq ft remains for driveways, sidewalks, patios, and other hardscape before hitting the IC ceiling. A two-story duplex with a smaller footprint would provide more IC headroom for site improvements. The developer must track IC carefully during design — exceeding 45% is a hard stop at permitting.
Recommended next step	Size the building footprint to leave adequate IC budget for driveways and walks. Consider pervious pavers or permeable materials for non-building hardscape to stay within the 45% limit. Cross-reference with the zoning/land-use (zlu) discipline for FAR and building coverage coordination.

3. Water Quality — Redevelopment Compliance

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	LDC Sec. 25-8-211; ECM Sec. 1.6.0; LDC Ch. 25-8 Subchapter A (Watershed Protection Ordinance — demolition/redevelopment)
Finding	Demolition of the existing SFR and construction of a new duplex constitutes redevelopment under Austin's Watershed Protection Ordinance. Redevelopment must comply with current water quality standards, including providing WQ controls for the developed impervious area. The WQ trigger threshold is 8,000 sq ft of new + redeveloped IC outside the BSZ. This lot's maximum IC (~3,528 sq ft) falls below the 8,000 sq ft trigger, which may exempt the project from on-site WQ controls entirely.
Implication	If the 8,000 sq ft WQ trigger is confirmed as not met, no structural water quality controls (rain garden, bioswale, sand filter) are required — a significant simplification. If WPD interprets the trigger differently for redevelopment (e.g., counting existing IC being replaced), the Scofield subdivision's existing regional WQ facilities may provide coverage, avoiding on-site treatment.

Recommended next step

Confirm with Watershed Protection Department (WPD) whether (a) the 8,000 sq ft IC threshold applies to this redevelopment, and (b) if triggered, whether existing Scofield regional facilities satisfy the WQ obligation for this lot.

4. No On-Site Detention Required

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	DCM Sec. 1.2.2.D (no-increase rule); Site Plan Lite Phase 2 drainage reforms; DCM Sec. 1.2.2.G (Simplified RSMP for sites up to 1 acre)
Finding	Under the Site Plan Lite drainage reforms, lots up to 1 acre draining to an existing system are exempt from on-site detention requirements. This lot at 0.18 acres qualifies. Independently, the DCM Simplified RSMP pathway (Sec. 1.2.2.G) would also cover SF lots up to 1 acre if detention were otherwise triggered. The no-increase rule (2-, 10-, 25-, 100-year storms) does not apply when the exemption is in effect.
Implication	No detention pond, underground vault, or other flood-control structure is needed on site. This preserves the full buildable area for the duplex and site improvements.
Recommended next step	No action required beyond confirming the Site Plan Lite exemption applies (see Finding 1).

5. RSMP Fee-in-Lieu Eligibility

Field	Detail
Severity	opportunity
Citation	DCM Sec. 8.2; DCM Sec. 1.2.2.G (Simplified RSMP); RSMP Participation Handbook
Finding	The RSMP allows qualifying developments to pay a fee-in-lieu of constructing on-site detention. For SF lots up to 1 acre, the Simplified RSMP pathway (DCM 1.2.2.G) applies — no three-scenario HEC-HMS modeling required. Walnut Creek is within COA full-purpose jurisdiction and is expected to be an eligible watershed, but this must be confirmed via the RSMP Feasibility Viewer.
Implication	RSMP is likely unnecessary given the Site Plan Lite detention exemption. However, if project scope changes (e.g., lot subdivision, additional units beyond duplex) push the project past the exemption threshold, RSMP provides a viable fallback. The RSMP feasibility meeting must occur before any formal Completeness Check — a sequencing requirement to keep in mind.
Recommended next step	Verify Walnut Creek watershed eligibility on the RSMP Feasibility Viewer (austintexas.gov/RSMP). No action needed now unless the project scope changes.

6. Floodplain — No Constraint

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	FEMA FIRM Panel 48453C0115E (effective 06/16/1993); property survey; LDC Sec. 25-7-92
Finding	The property is in FEMA Zone X — outside the 100-year and 500-year floodplain. The site sits at approximately 850-870 ft elevation, well above the Walnut Creek floodplain corridor. No COA fully-developed 100-year floodplain encroachment is expected given the upland location. No floodplain development permit, CLOMR/LOMR, or elevation certificate is required.
Implication	No floodplain-related restrictions on building placement, grading, or finished floor elevation. Cross-referenced with the floodplain (fwp) discipline — confirmed Zone X, no creek buffer applies.
Recommended next step	None.

7. EARZ and CEF — No Constraint

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	TCEQ Edwards Aquifer Protection Program, 30 TAC Ch. 213; LDC Sec. 25-8-281 et seq.; ECM Sec. 1.10.0; ECM Sec. 1.12
Finding	The property is not within the Edwards Aquifer Recharge Zone or Contributing Zone. No TCEQ Edwards Aquifer Protection Plan (EAPP) is required. No known Critical Environmental Features (caves, sinkholes, springs, rimrock) exist at or adjacent to the site. The EARZ-specific prohibitions (clay liner prohibition, void mitigation, geomembrane requirements) do not apply.
Implication	No EARZ-related design constraints, liner requirements, or void mitigation protocols. No CEF buffers (150-300 ft) restrict the buildable area.
Recommended next step	CEF status will be formally confirmed via the Environmental Resource Inventory (ERI) form required at permitting. No early action needed.

8. Erosion Hazard Zone — Not Triggered

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	DCM Appendix E; LDC Sec. 25-7-32

NOETIC

Finding	EHZ analysis is required when a site is within 100 ft of a waterway centerline with a drainage area of 64 acres or more. The Scofield subdivision is an upland residential area with no major waterway within 100 ft of this lot. No EHZ analysis is required.
Implication	No erosion setback restricts the buildable area.
Recommended next step	None.

9. Storm Drain Connection — Verify Proximity

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	DCM Sec. 1.2.3.C (as amended 9-8-2025)
Finding	A storm drain connection is required when a site is within 300 ft of an existing storm drain system. Scofield is a fully developed subdivision with curb-and-gutter streets that likely include storm drain infrastructure. The Site Plan Lite exemption from drainage review may moot this requirement for a duplex, but the underlying obligation to connect to (and not adversely affect) existing infrastructure remains.
Implication	If the lot drains to the street and the street drains to a functioning storm system, the requirement is satisfied by default. If the lot has rear-yard drainage that does not reach the street, site grading must ensure positive drainage to the public system.
Recommended next step	Confirm during design that the finished grade directs all runoff to Cinchring Ln and the existing curb/inlet system. No formal storm drain design is expected to be required.

10. S.M.A.R.T. Housing RSMP Discount

Field	Detail
Severity	opportunity
Citation	RSMP Participation Handbook (FY24); S.M.A.R.T. Housing Policy
Finding	If RSMP participation is pursued, a 10-50% payment discount is available for projects with S.M.A.R.T. Housing certification (10-50% affordable units maintained for 40+ years). For a 2-unit duplex, this would require dedicating 1 unit as income-restricted.
Implication	Only relevant if (a) RSMP participation becomes necessary and (b) the developer is pursuing an affordability-linked project. At this scale, the RSMP fee itself is modest, so the discount may not justify the 40-year affordability commitment.
Recommended next step	Evaluate only if project scope changes to trigger detention requirements and the developer is interested in affordability programs.

NOETIC

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Site Plan Lite applicability to demo-and-rebuild redevelopment.** Does the drainage review exemption (lots $\leq 11,500$ sq ft) apply to demolition-and-new-construction on an existing platted lot, or only to greenfield construction? Confirm with DSD before relying on the exemption.
2. **WQ trigger for this IC level.** The site's maximum IC (~3,528 sq ft) is below the 8,000 sq ft WQ trigger threshold. Confirm with WPD that this threshold applies to redevelopment IC (replaced + new) and that the project is exempt from structural water quality controls.
3. **Scofield regional WQ facilities.** If WQ controls are triggered, do existing regional stormwater facilities serving the Scofield subdivision satisfy the water quality obligation for this lot? The subdivision was developed in the late 1980s/early 1990s and may have regional ponds. WPD confirmation is needed.
4. **Existing drainage pattern.** Does the lot currently drain entirely to Cinchring Ln (front), or does any portion drain to the rear or side toward adjacent lots? Positive drainage to the street is assumed but should be confirmed by a topographic survey or site visit before design.
5. **RSMP watershed eligibility.** Is Walnut Creek confirmed as a participating RSMP watershed on the Feasibility Viewer? This is a contingency question — only matters if the project scope changes beyond the Site Plan Lite exemption threshold.
6. **IC accounting method.** For the 45% IC limit, does WPD use gross lot area (~7,840 sq ft) or net site area (excluding easements/ROW dedications) as the denominator? The 5-ft PUE along the lot line and any ROW dedication could reduce the effective denominator and tighten the IC budget.
7. **Interbasin diversion.** Confirm that the lot drains entirely within the Walnut Creek watershed and that no grading changes would divert runoff across a watershed boundary (unlikely given the suburban setting, but required for due diligence under LDC Sec. 25-8-365).

Cross-references: Impervious cover limit is also governed by zoning (zlu discipline — 45% SF-2); floodplain status confirmed Zone X by fwp discipline; environmental constraints (no EARZ, no CEF) confirmed by environmental research; Site Plan Lite eligibility confirmed by programs research.

Floodplain Findings --- 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 --- Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Watershed:** Walnut Creek (Suburban) **Date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **No floodplain encumbrance.** The property is in FEMA Zone X (FIRM Panel 48453C0115E, effective 06/16/1993), outside both the 100-year and 500-year floodplain. The survey confirms this determination. No floodplain development permit, elevation certificate, CLOMR/LOMR, or ASCE 24 certification is required.
- **No CWQZ, EHZ, or CEF constraints identified.** The lot is an upland site at approximately 850--870 ft elevation, well above the Walnut Creek floodplain corridor. No classified waterway is on or immediately adjacent to the parcel, and no Critical Water Quality Zone, Erosion Hazard Zone, or Critical Environmental Feature buffers encroach on the site.
- **No floodway (COA 25-yr) or COA fully-developed 100-yr floodplain impact.** The upland position places the site outside both the FEMA SFHA and the City of Austin's fully-developed-conditions floodplain, which can be broader than FEMA in Atlas 14-updated watersheds. Neither boundary reaches this lot.
- **No drainage easement encumbrance for floodplain purposes.** The recorded easements (5-ft PUE, blanket electrical easement, ingress/egress utility easement) are utility-related; no drainage easement is recorded on the plat, and none is required because the regulatory 100-yr floodplain does not cross the parcel.
- **This discipline presents no material constraint to the proposed duplex development.** The floodplain assessment is complete and favorable. Remaining environmental obligations (impervious cover, water quality controls, tree survey, BCCP fee) are addressed in the Environmental Landscape and Site Drainage disciplines.

Findings

1. FEMA Flood Zone Determination

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** FEMA FIRM Panel 48453C0115E, effective 06/16/1993; property survey; DCM 1.2.6.B
- **Finding:** The property is mapped in FEMA Zone X --- areas determined to be outside both the 1% annual chance (100-year) and 0.2% annual chance (500-year) floodplains. The survey explicitly states the property does not lie within the 100-year flood prone area. Zone X designation means no Special Flood Hazard Area (SFHA) applies.
- **Implication for the developer:** No FEMA-related floodplain obligations attach to this site. No flood insurance purchase requirement under NFIP. No elevation certificate, floodplain development permit, or FEMA map amendment (CLOMR/LOMR) is needed. No ASCE 24-14 structural compliance is required.
- **Recommended next step:** None. Retain the FIRM panel citation and survey flood zone note in the project file for the building permit application.

2. City of Austin Fully-Developed 100-Year Floodplain

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** LDC Ch. 25-7; LDC Ch. 25-12; DCM 1.2.6.A-B; Rule R161-20.01 (Atlas 14)

- **Finding:** The COA fully-developed 100-year floodplain, derived from City regulatory hydraulic models with Atlas 14 rainfall data (where applicable), does not extend to this upland lot. The Walnut Creek floodplain corridor lies at materially lower elevations. This is consistent with the site's 850--870 ft elevation and its position within a fully built-out subdivision on higher ground. No COA floodplain boundary encroaches on the parcel.
- **Implication for the developer:** No COA floodplain development permit is required. No compensatory storage, no-rise analysis, or freeboard calculations are needed. The project is not subject to the COA 25-year floodway zero-rise standard (LDC 25-12-54).
- **Recommended next step:** Confirm the COA GIS floodplain layer at site plan submission as a procedural step. No engineering analysis required.

3. CWQZ / WQTZ Applicability

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** LDC 25-8-261; ECM 1.5.2; DCM 1.2.6.A.1 (64-acre classified waterway threshold)
- **Finding:** Critical Water Quality Zone buffers in Suburban watersheds apply to classified waterways with 64 or more acres of contributing drainage area. No such waterway is on or immediately adjacent to this lot. The lot is an interior subdivision parcel surrounded by other residential lots and local streets, with no surface water feature or classified drainage channel present. The CWQZ does not encroach on the site.
- **Implication for the developer:** No CWQZ use restrictions apply. No buffer averaging analysis or LUC variance under the enhanced LDC 25-8-41(B) standard is needed. Proposed building and impervious cover placement is unconstrained by CWQZ.
- **Recommended next step:** None.

4. Erosion Hazard Zone (EHZ) Applicability

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** LDC 25-7-32(C); DCM Appendix E
- **Finding:** EHZ analysis is triggered when development is within 100 ft of a classified waterway centerline (64 or more acres drainage area). No classified waterway is within 100 ft of this lot. No EHZ has been identified or is expected.
- **Implication for the developer:** No EHZ setback analysis, meander belt delineation, or WPD/ERM concurrence on protective works is required.
- **Recommended next step:** None.

5. Critical Environmental Features (CEFs)

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** LDC 25-8-281; ECM 1.10.0; City of Austin Watershed Protection karst database
- **Finding:** No known CEFs (springs, caves, sinkholes, point recharge features, rimrock, bluffs) have been identified at or immediately adjacent to the site. The Scofield subdivision in north Austin is developed on Cretaceous-age formations not typically associated with significant karst features. The Edwards Aquifer Recharge Zone is well south of this property.
- **Implication for the developer:** No 150-ft CEF protective buffer applies. No administrative or LUC variance for CEF setback reduction is needed.
- **Recommended next step:** The Environmental Resource Inventory (ERI) form, required at site plan application, will provide formal City confirmation of CEF status. This is a procedural requirement, not a risk item.

6. FIRM Panel Age

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** FIRM Panel 48453C0115E, effective 06/16/1993
- **Finding:** The effective FIRM panel dates to 1993. While older panels can sometimes be superseded by preliminary FIRMs from watershed restudies, a Zone X determination on an upland lot at 850--870 ft elevation is extremely unlikely to be affected by any FEMA restudy of the Walnut Creek watershed. No pending preliminary FIRM affecting this panel has been identified.
- **Implication for the developer:** The 1993 effective date does not create risk for this parcel. The Zone X designation is stable.
- **Recommended next step:** As a best practice, confirm at permit application that no preliminary FIRM has been published for this panel. This is low-effort and low-risk.

7. Drainage Easement Status

- **Severity:** note
- **Citation:** LDC 25-7-152; plat records (Cabinet 91, Slide 264-265)
- **Finding:** The recorded easements on this lot (5-ft PUE, blanket electrical easement, ingress/egress utility easement) are utility-related. No drainage easement is recorded, and none is required because the regulatory 100-year floodplain does not cross the parcel. The drainage easement dedication requirement (LDC 25-7-152) applies only where the regulatory floodplain exists on a lot.
- **Implication for the developer:** No drainage easement dedication or variance is needed.
- **Recommended next step:** None.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Atlas 14 watershed amendment status for Walnut Creek:** Has the Walnut Creek watershed been updated to Atlas 14 rainfall per Rule R161-20.01 (effective 2019-11-25)? This does not affect the floodplain determination for this upland lot, but should be documented for completeness and in case any drainage study is required for site plan review.
2. **Preliminary FIRM check:** Has FEMA published any preliminary FIRM panels for the Walnut Creek watershed that would supersede Panel 48453C0115E? Again, unlikely to affect a Zone X upland lot, but confirm for the file.
3. **Contributing drainage area to the lot:** Does any concentrated flow path with 64 or more acres of contributing drainage area cross or abut the lot? The answer is almost certainly no given the interior subdivision location, but the engineer should confirm this at the site plan stage per DCM 1.2.6.A.1.

Environmental Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR (built 1993); build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Watershed:** Walnut Creek — Suburban classification **Date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **No high-severity environmental barriers** to the proposed duplex. The site is outside the Edwards Aquifer recharge/contributing zone (no EAPP), outside the 100-year and 500-year floodplain (Zone X), and carries no known Critical Environmental Features.
- **Asbestos survey is required before demolition** of the 1993 house under TCEQ NESHAP regulations (40 CFR 61, Subpart M); lead-based paint screening is also recommended given the pre-1996 construction date.
- **No Phase I ESA has been performed** — a recognized data gap. Residential use history suggests low contamination risk, but a Phase I is recommended before demolition to document the absence of Recognized Environmental Conditions and satisfy lender/investor due diligence.
- **BCCP participation fee applies** at building permit issuance; no individual USFWS Section 7 or Section 10 consultation is anticipated.
- **Tree protection, floodplain, and stormwater** matters are cross-referenced to their respective disciplines (eftp, fwp, sde) and are not duplicated here.

Findings

1. Walnut Creek Suburban Watershed Classification

Severity: note **Citation:** Austin LDC Ch. 25-8, Sec. 25-8-2; Ch. 25-8 Article 9 (Suburban Watershed Requirements) **Finding:** The property lies within the Walnut Creek watershed, classified as Suburban under Chapter 25-8. Suburban watershed rules (Article 9) govern impervious cover limits and water quality controls. For this lot, the SF-2 zoning IC limit of 45% is expected to control over the watershed IC limit, but the more restrictive of the two applies. Water quality controls (sedimentation/filtration per ECM Sec. 1.6.0) are required for redevelopment; however, the Scofield subdivision may already be served by regional water quality facilities, which could satisfy the lot-level obligation. **Implication for the developer:** The suburban watershed classification does not block the project but establishes the regulatory framework for impervious cover and water quality. Confirm whether existing regional controls serve this lot — if not, an on-site SCM may be required. **Recommended next step:** Confirm lot-level IC limit and regional WQ facility coverage with the Watershed Protection Department during pre-application. Cross-reference stormwater controls to the **sde** discipline.

2. Not in Edwards Aquifer Recharge or Contributing Zone

Severity: note **Citation:** TCEQ 30 TAC Chapter 213; Travis County Aquifer Maps **Finding:** The property is not within the Edwards Aquifer Recharge Zone (EARZ) or Contributing Zone. The EARZ in Travis County is concentrated south of the Colorado River over exposed Edwards Group limestones. North Austin (Scofield area) overlies different geologic formations. No TCEQ Edwards Aquifer Protection Plan (EAPP) is required. **Implication for the developer:** Eliminates the EAPP application, associated engineering, and TCEQ review timeline from the project scope. This is favorable. **Recommended next step:** None required.

3. No Known Critical Environmental Features

Severity: note **Citation:** Austin LDC Sec. 25-8-281 et seq.; ECM Sec. 1.10.0; City of Austin Watershed Protection karst database **Finding:** CEFs in Austin include springs, caves, sinkholes, point recharge features,

rimrock, and bluffs. No known CEFs have been identified at or immediately adjacent to 12713 Cinchring Ln. The site's geology (Cretaceous formations in north Austin, not Edwards Limestone) carries low probability of karst features. The City's karst database (~550 points) is concentrated in western and southwestern Austin.

Implication for the developer: Low risk. However, an Environmental Resource Inventory (ERI) form is required as part of the building permit application, and Watershed Protection staff will make the formal CEF determination during review. If a CEF were identified, a 150-ft to 300-ft protective buffer would encumber the lot — on a 7,840 sq ft parcel, this would be project-fatal. **Recommended next step:** Complete the ERI form at permitting. No pre-application CEF investigation is warranted given the low geological probability.

4. BCCP Participation Area — Fee Applies

Severity: note **Citation:** USFWS Balcones Canyonlands Conservation Plan (BCCP), 1996; Travis County BCCP participation area maps **Finding:** The property is within the BCCP participation area. The BCCP provides an Incidental Take Permit covering development within the permit area for 14 federally listed species (including golden-cheeked warbler and six karst invertebrates). The site — a fully developed suburban lot — does not contain warbler nesting habitat or known karst invertebrate habitat. The BCCP Participation Fee is collected at building permit issuance. **Implication for the developer:** The fee is a modest line item (typically a few hundred dollars for residential development). No individual USFWS consultation is needed. **Recommended next step:** Budget for the BCCP fee. Confirm current fee schedule with DSD at time of permit application.

5. No Wetlands Expected

Severity: note **Citation:** USFWS National Wetlands Inventory (NWI); Clean Water Act Section 404 **Finding:** The site is an upland suburban lot in Zone X (no floodplain), on well-drained soils with no surface water features on or adjacent to the parcel. No jurisdictional wetlands are expected. No Section 404 permit or Army Corps of Engineers coordination is anticipated. **Implication for the developer:** No wetland constraints on site layout or construction sequencing. **Recommended next step:** Confirm via NWI Wetlands Mapper for documentation completeness. A formal wetland delineation is not warranted.

6. Phase I ESA Not Performed

Severity: data-gap **Citation:** ASTM E1527-21 (Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments) **Finding:** No Phase I ESA has been commissioned for the property. The site has been in single-family residential use since the subdivision was developed in the early 1990s; prior use was rangeland/agricultural. No TCEQ State Superfund, EPA NPL, or LUST sites have been identified at this address in available databases. The contamination risk profile is low. However, without a Phase I, potential concerns — historical agricultural chemicals, adjacent-parcel USTs, vapor intrusion — cannot be formally excluded. **Implication for the developer:** Most lenders and investors require a Phase I ESA for acquisition or construction financing. The absence of a Phase I does not block permitting but creates a due-diligence gap. The low-risk residential history makes an adverse finding unlikely, but the assessment is the documentation vehicle. **Recommended next step:** Commission a Phase I ESA (ASTM E1527-21) before demolition. This can run concurrent with design; typical turnaround is 3-4 weeks, cost \$2,000-\$4,000.

7. Asbestos Survey Required Before Demolition (TCEQ NESHAP)

Severity: moderate **Citation:** 40 CFR 61, Subpart M (National Emission Standards for Hazardous Air Pollutants — Asbestos); TCEQ Asbestos Program; Texas DSHS Asbestos Health Protection Rules (25 TAC 295) **Finding:** The existing house was built in 1993. Asbestos-containing materials (ACM) were used in residential construction through the mid-1990s, particularly in floor tiles, joint compound, roofing materials, pipe insulation, and textite siding. Under the federal NESHAP rule, the owner/operator must conduct a thorough asbestos inspection of a facility before demolition, performed by a Texas-licensed asbestos inspector. If ACM is found, abatement must be completed by a licensed contractor before demolition, and a 10-working-day notification to TCEQ is required prior to the start of demolition or abatement. **Implication for the developer:** This is a hard prerequisite to demolition. The inspection adds 1-2 weeks; if ACM is found, abatement adds

2-4 weeks and \$3,000-\$15,000+ depending on materials and quantities. Schedule the inspection early.

Recommended next step: Engage a Texas-licensed asbestos inspector to survey the existing structure. If ACM is identified, obtain abatement bids and factor cost/schedule into the demolition plan. File the TCEQ 10-day notification before any demolition activity.

8. Lead-Based Paint Screening Recommended

Severity: note **Citation:** 40 CFR 745 (Lead-Based Paint); HUD/EPA Renovation, Repair and Painting (RRP) Rule; Texas DSHS 25 TAC 295 Subchapter I **Finding:** The house was built in 1993. The Consumer Product Safety Commission banned lead-based paint for residential use in 1978, so the structure is unlikely to contain LBP. However, lead can be present in plumbing solder (pre-1986 ban) and in some specialty coatings. For a full demolition, lead risk is minimal but should be addressed as part of the asbestos/hazmat survey scope. **Implication for the developer:** Low likelihood of encountering LBP. Including lead screening in the asbestos survey scope adds negligible marginal cost. **Recommended next step:** Include LBP screening in the asbestos inspection scope as a precautionary measure.

9. Low Contamination Risk — Residential History

Severity: note **Citation:** TCEQ State Superfund and LUST databases; EPA NPL **Finding:** The Scofield subdivision was platted and built as a residential community in the late 1980s through 1990s. Prior land use was undeveloped rangeland. No TCEQ Superfund, LUST, or EPA NPL sites have been identified at this address. Surrounding land uses are residential and low-density commercial. The contamination risk is low and consistent with typical suburban residential property. **Implication for the developer:** No brownfield or remediation concerns are anticipated. A Phase I ESA (Finding 6) would provide formal documentation. **Recommended next step:** Addressed via Phase I ESA recommendation (Finding 6).

10. Floodplain — Zone X, No Constraints

Severity: note **Citation:** FEMA FIRM Panel 48453C0115E, effective 06/16/1993; property survey **Finding:** The property is in FEMA Zone X, outside both the 100-year and 500-year floodplain. No floodplain development permit, CLOMR/LOMR, or elevation certificate is required. The site sits at approximately 850-870 ft elevation, well above the Walnut Creek floodplain corridor. **Implication for the developer:** No floodplain constraints on building design, finished floor elevation, or construction sequencing. **Recommended next step:** None. Cross-reference to the **fwp** discipline for any local drainage or creek-buffer considerations.

11. Tree Protection — Cross-Reference to eptp

Severity: note **Citation:** Austin LDC Ch. 25-8, Subchapter B (Tree and Natural Area Protection) **Finding:** Austin's tree protection ordinance applies to all development. Heritage trees (19+ inches diameter at 4.5 ft) require a removal permit with mitigation; protected trees (8+ inches) require mitigation if removed. The lot may contain mature trees established during or after subdivision development (30+ years of growth). A tree survey is required as part of the building permit application. **Implication for the developer:** Heritage or protected trees, if present, could constrain the building footprint or require mitigation fees. On a 7,840 sq ft lot with 40% max building coverage, tree locations materially affect site layout. **Recommended next step:** This is fully addressed in the **eptp** discipline. Conduct a tree survey early in design to inform footprint placement.

12. Soil Conditions — High Shrink-Swell Clay

Severity: note **Citation:** USDA Web Soil Survey; Blackland Prairie ecological region data **Finding:** The site is in the Blackland Prairie region with deep, dark, clay-rich Vertisol soils (likely Houston Black clay series). These soils have high shrink-swell potential, expanding when wet and contracting when dry. This is the dominant foundation risk in the Austin area. **Implication for the developer:** An engineered foundation (post-tensioned slab or drilled piers) is required. A geotechnical report should inform foundation design. **Recommended next step:** Commission a geotechnical investigation before foundation design. Typical cost \$2,500-\$5,000; turnaround 2-3 weeks.

13. Wildfire Risk — Low

Severity: note **Citation:** City of Austin Wildfire Division; Texas Wildfire Risk Assessment Portal (TxWRAP)

Finding: Scofield Farms is a flat, fully developed suburban neighborhood with no wildland-urban interface exposure. Wildfire risk in Austin is concentrated in the Edwards Plateau / Hill Country areas to the west and southwest. This site is classified as low wildfire risk. **Implication for the developer:** No wildfire-specific construction standards are triggered. **Recommended next step:** None. Confirm WUI boundary status via Austin GIS if HOME Phase 2 fire-resistive construction standards become relevant to a future subdivision scenario.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Regional water quality controls:** Does the Scofield subdivision have existing regional WQ facilities that serve Lot 12, Block M? If so, the lot-level on-site SCM requirement may be satisfied. Confirm with Watershed Protection Department.
2. **Asbestos survey results:** Until the asbestos inspection is complete, the demolition schedule and cost carry uncertainty. Are there any known renovation or abatement records for the existing house?
3. **Geotechnical conditions:** Has any prior geotechnical work been performed on adjacent lots in this section of Scofield that could inform foundation assumptions before commissioning a site-specific investigation?
4. **Phase I ESA scope:** Will the developer's lender require a Phase I ESA? If so, this should be initiated immediately to avoid holding up the closing or construction loan timeline.
5. **Existing sanitary sewer vault:** The seed data notes a concrete sanitary sewer vault on site. What is the vault's function and disposition plan — remove, cap, or re-use? Austin Water should confirm before demolition planning is finalized. (Cross-reference to **wwp** discipline.)

Tree Protection & Erosion Control Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning, Walnut Creek watershed (Suburban) **Date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **No tree survey has been conducted.** This is the single largest data gap in this discipline. The house was built in 1993, giving the lot over 30 years of tree growth. Without a field survey by an RPLS with ISA-certified arborist support, the presence, species, and diameter of regulated, protected, or heritage trees cannot be determined, and no reliable building envelope can be drawn.
- **Heritage tree risk is plausible but unquantified.** Scofield-era lots in north Austin commonly have live oaks, cedar elms, and pecans — all heritage-eligible species under LDC 25-8-602(1). Any specimen at or above 24" DBH would trigger administrative variance, 300% caliper-inch mitigation, and prerequisite-variance sequencing that adds 2-4+ months to the entitlement timeline.
- **Standard erosion and sedimentation controls apply but pose low risk.** The lot is small (0.18 ac), in an urban/suburban watershed with no BSZ overlay, no floodplain, no EARZ, no known CEFs, and flat topography. ESC requirements are routine and should not constrain the project.
- **No environmental overlays (BSZ, EARZ, CWQZ, Hill Country Roadway Corridor) apply** to this site, eliminating the most severe tree and erosion regulatory pathways (phased ESC, SOS impervious caps, karst surveys, ERI).
- **The demolition itself triggers ESC plan and tree protection obligations.** Tree protection fencing must be installed before any demolition activity begins; demolition equipment, staging, and debris storage within a CRZ of any regulated tree constitutes a code violation.

Findings

1. Tree Survey Not Conducted — Cannot Define Buildable Envelope

Severity: data-gap

Citation: ECM 3.3.1.A; ECM 3.3.2.A (RPLS-certified tree survey required within 5 years of submittal for all trees $\geq 8"$ DBH on site, on adjacent property with CRZ entering the LOC, or in the adjacent ROW)

Finding: No tree survey has been performed for this property. The lot has been developed since 1993, providing 30+ years for trees to reach protected ($\geq 19"$ DBH) or heritage ($\geq 24"$ DBH, listed species) status. Satellite and street-level imagery cannot substitute for field measurement — DBH at 4.5 ft above natural grade is the only valid metric for regulatory classification.

Implication for the developer: Without a tree survey, it is impossible to determine whether any heritage or protected trees exist, whether CRZs constrain the building footprint, or what mitigation costs may apply. All massing and site plan work performed before the survey is speculative and may require wholesale revision.

Recommended next step: Commission an RPLS-certified tree survey with ISA-certified arborist species identification and condition rating before investing in architectural design. The survey must include trees on adjacent lots and in the ROW whose CRZ (radius in feet = DBH in inches) reaches into the LOC. Budget approximately \$1,500-\$3,000 for the survey on a lot this size.

2. Potential Heritage Trees — Variance and Mitigation Exposure

Severity: moderate

Citation: LDC 25-8-602(1) (heritage species list); LDC 25-8-642 (admin variance for heritage < 30" stem); LDC 25-8-643 (LUC + EC variance for >= 30" stem); ECM 3.5.4.A.1 (300% mitigation rate)

Finding: Heritage species common to north Austin Blackland Prairie / Scofield-era landscaping include live oak (*Quercus virginiana*), cedar elm (*Ulmus crassifolia*), and pecan (*Carya illinoensis*) — all listed under LDC 25-8-602(1). A tree planted at subdivision development (circa 1990-1993) could now exceed 24" DBH, qualifying as a heritage tree. Removal of a heritage tree requires an administrative variance (or LUC + EC variance if any stem >= 30"), prerequisite-variance exhaustion under LDC 25-8-646, and mitigation at 300% of removed caliper inches.

Implication for the developer: If a 24" heritage oak must be removed, mitigation alone would cost approximately \$14,400 (24" x 300% = 72 caliper inches x \$200/inch fee-in-lieu) — and fee-in-lieu is only available if the City Arborist determines the site is unsuitable for replanting. On-site replanting of 72 caliper inches of significant shade providers is the default and requires substantial planting area. The prerequisite-variance requirement (LDC 25-8-646) adds 2-4 months of calendar time before the heritage variance can even be filed.

Recommended next step: Complete the tree survey (Finding 1). If heritage trees are present, engage the City Arborist early to discuss preservation alternatives, potential MCRZ approval, or DDI status if condition is poor. Design massing around heritage CRZs rather than planning for removal.

3. Protected Tree Removal Likely — Mitigation Cost to Budget

Severity: moderate

Citation: LDC 25-8-624(A) (removal criteria); ECM 3.5.4.A.1 (100% mitigation for 19"+ Appendix F species; 50% for non-Appendix F 19"+; 50%/25% for 8-18.9")

Finding: On a 7,840 sq ft lot where the entire existing house, driveway, and yard will be demolished and replaced with a larger duplex footprint, removal of one or more protected trees (>= 19" DBH) is probable. Even trees in the 8-18.9" range require a removal permit and mitigation (50% if Appendix F species, 25% otherwise).

Implication for the developer: Mitigation costs for protected (non-heritage) trees are more manageable — a 20" protected Appendix F tree would require 20 caliper inches of replacement (100% rate), or \$4,000 fee-in-lieu. Multiple removals could accumulate to \$5,000-\$15,000 depending on inventory. At least 75% of replacement caliper must be Significant Shade Provider species.

Recommended next step: After the tree survey, map all regulated trees against the proposed building footprint, driveways, utility trenches, and staging areas. Optimize the site plan to preserve the largest trees and minimize mitigation obligations.

4. Critical Root Zone Constraints on Duplex Footprint

Severity: moderate

Citation: ECM 3.5.2.A.1 (CRZ radius = DBH in inches, measured in feet; 50% preservation rule; Half CRZ <= 4" cut/fill; Quarter CRZ zero disturbance); ECM 3.5.2.A.3 (impacts measured at line of excavation, not face of improvements)

Finding: On a small lot (7,840 sq ft), the CRZ of even a single large tree can consume a significant portion of the buildable area. A 24" tree has a 24-ft CRZ radius (1,810 sq ft circle), a 12-ft Half CRZ, and a 6-ft Quarter CRZ with zero tolerance for any cut or fill. The CRZ of trees on adjacent lots or in the Cinchring Ln ROW that extends into this lot is subject to the same rules. Austin measures construction impacts at the line of excavation — over-excavation, form bracing, scaffolding, and utility trenching all count.

Implication for the developer: A heritage or large protected tree near the center or front of the lot could eliminate duplex configurations that require full-width building footprints. The Quarter CRZ prohibition is

absolute and frequently constrains sidewalks, curbs, and utility laterals. The City Arborist may impose an enlarged CRZ (1.25x-1.5x) for Post Oak, further compressing the envelope.

Recommended next step: Once the tree survey is complete, plot CRZ, Half CRZ, and Quarter CRZ circles on the site plan at the concept stage, before committing to massing. Evaluate elevated foundation options within the Half CRZ (ECM 3.5.2.B.3) and like-for-like existing impacts (ECM 3.5.2.B.4.a) where the existing house slab already encroaches.

5. Erosion and Sedimentation Control — Routine Requirements

Severity: note

Citation: LDC 25-8-181; ECM 1.4 (ESC plan required for all development); ECM 1.4.4.B.3 (LOC-based quantities)

Finding: An ESC plan is required for demolition and construction. The site is small (0.18 ac), flat, in the Walnut Creek suburban watershed, outside the BSZ, and below all phasing thresholds (LOC < 25 ac). Standard ESC measures apply: silt fence at downslope LOC perimeter, stabilized construction entrance (≥ 50 ft crushed stone pad, ≥ 8 " thick), and inlet protection for any nearby storm drains. No phased ESC plan, no 18-month revegetation cap, and no cut/fill > 4 ft disclosure are required (urban/suburban watershed exemption).

Implication for the developer: ESC compliance is straightforward and should not affect project schedule or cost materially. The civil engineer will include the ESC plan on the site plan sheets at 1"=50' scale.

Recommended next step: Include ESC in the civil engineering scope. Ensure the stabilized construction entrance is feasible given the lot frontage and any existing street trees in the ROW.

6. Demolition-Phase Tree Protection Obligations

Severity: note

Citation: ECM 3.6.1 (tree protection fencing); SSM 610.4.A (chain-link ≥ 5 ft at CRZ boundary; trunk wrap within 5 ft); ECM 3.5.2.A.3 (construction impacts include staging and equipment)

Finding: Tree protection fencing must be installed before demolition begins — not just before new construction. Demolition equipment, debris staging, material storage, and truck access within the CRZ of any regulated tree (≥ 8 " DBH) constitutes a code violation and can trigger reclassification of the tree as "removed," with full mitigation consequences. The existing concrete driveway and house slab provide some protection during demolition if trees are behind the structure, but heavy equipment tracking across root zones outside the existing impervious footprint is prohibited without 8" mulch and plywood/mat protection.

Implication for the developer: The demolition contractor must be briefed on tree protection requirements. Demolition and tree protection plans should be coordinated — tree fencing is a precondition to the demolition permit, not a later site-plan item.

Recommended next step: Once the tree survey identifies regulated trees, prepare a tree protection plan that covers both the demolition and construction phases. Specify fencing locations and trunk wrap requirements in the demolition scope of work.

7. No Environmental Overlays — Favorable Regulatory Position

Severity: opportunity

Citation: Environmental research confirms: not in BSZ (LDC 25-8-481); not in EARZ (30 TAC Ch. 213); not in CWQZ; no known CEFs (LDC 25-8-281); no Hill Country Roadway Corridor; Zone X (no floodplain); no wetlands expected

Finding: The property is free of the environmental overlays that trigger the most burdensome tree and erosion requirements in Austin. There is no BSZ impervious cover cap, no phased ESC, no ERI requirement (no slopes > 15%, no EARZ, no wetlands within 150 ft), no karst survey, no CWQZ buffer, and no Hill Country Roadway Corridor native-tree replacement or 40% natural-area set-aside.

Implication for the developer: The regulatory pathway for tree protection and erosion control is limited to the standard citywide tree ordinance (LDC Ch. 25-8 Subchapter B) and standard ESC (LDC 25-8-181). This is the simplest regulatory posture available in Austin and should not introduce material schedule risk beyond the tree survey and any resulting variance proceedings.

Recommended next step: No action needed on environmental overlays. Focus diligence resources on the tree survey and heritage/protected tree analysis.

8. Like-for-Like Existing Impacts — Potential Opportunity

Severity: opportunity

Citation: ECM 3.5.2.B.4.a (rebuilding within footprint of existing Half- or Quarter-CRZ impacts is allowable if no deeper or wider)

Finding: The existing house, driveway, and concrete sewer vault have occupied portions of this lot since 1993. If any regulated trees have CRZs that overlap these existing impervious surfaces, the developer may claim like-for-like existing impacts — meaning new construction within the same footprint and depth as the existing improvements does not count as additional CRZ encroachment. This is particularly valuable on a small infill lot where the existing slab may already be within a Half or Quarter CRZ.

Implication for the developer: This opportunity is only quantifiable after the tree survey. If a heritage tree's CRZ overlaps the existing house slab, rebuilding within that same footprint avoids triggering the CRZ preservation rules for that area, potentially saving the project from a variance requirement.

Recommended next step: Document the existing house footprint, driveway, and sewer vault locations precisely (from the existing survey or demolition plan) before demolition. Overlay these against CRZs from the tree survey to identify like-for-like credit areas.

9. Landscape Replacement Requirements for New Duplex

Severity: note

Citation: LDC 25-2-1001 et seq.; ECM Section 2 (landscape and parking lot tree requirements)

Finding: The new duplex must comply with Austin's landscape requirements, including minimum tree plantings and landscaped area percentages. For residential development on a single lot, the requirements are less onerous than commercial or multifamily site plans, but tree replacement plantings (from any removal mitigation) count toward landscape compliance. At least 75% of replacement caliper must be Significant Shade Provider species per ECM Appendix F.

Implication for the developer: Landscape compliance is routine but should be coordinated with tree mitigation replanting to avoid double-counting issues. On a 7,840 sq ft lot with a duplex footprint, available planting area may be limited.

Recommended next step: Include landscape plan in the civil/site plan scope. Coordinate with the arborist on species selection for any mitigation replanting to satisfy both mitigation and landscape requirements simultaneously.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Tree survey:** Has any informal tree inventory or site visit been conducted? Are there any known large trees on the lot, on adjacent lots near the property line, or in the Cinchring Ln ROW? Even informal observations (species, approximate size, location) would help scope the RPLS survey and flag likely heritage candidates.

NOETIC

2. **Existing site survey:** Does the existing boundary survey show tree locations or canopy outlines? The seed data references a survey (FIRM panel, easements, building line) but does not mention tree symbology.
3. **Duplex massing flexibility:** How flexible is the building footprint? If heritage trees are found, can the duplex be reconfigured (e.g., stacked units, narrower footprint, shifted placement) to avoid CRZ conflicts, or is the program fixed?
4. **Existing house footprint dimensions:** What are the precise dimensions and location of the existing house slab, driveway, and sewer vault? These are needed to evaluate like-for-like existing impact credit (ECM 3.5.2.B.4.a) against any CRZ overlaps.
5. **Demolition sequencing:** Is there a preferred demolition contractor or timeline? Tree protection fencing must be in place before any demolition activity; this needs to be communicated to the demo team.
6. **Adjacent lot trees:** Are there large trees on the neighboring properties (especially to the sides and rear) whose canopies overhang or approach the property line? A tree with CRZ extending into this lot from an adjacent parcel is subject to the same protection rules as an on-site tree.
7. **Budget tolerance for mitigation:** What is the developer's budget tolerance for tree mitigation fees? Heritage tree mitigation at 300% can run \$10,000-\$25,000+ per tree; understanding cost sensitivity will help prioritize preservation vs. removal strategies once the survey is complete.

Transportation Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Frontage:** Cinchring Ln (ASMP Level 1, local residential, City of Austin)

Summary

- **No Traffic Impact Analysis (TIA) required.** The duplex generates approximately 10 net new daily trips, far below Austin's 2,000-trip TIA threshold. No TIA Determination Worksheet filing is necessary.
- **No ROW dedication anticipated.** Cinchring Ln is an ASMP Level 1 street with a 50-ft ROW standard; the existing platted ROW already meets this width, so no dedication delta exists.
- **Driveway permit required.** Demolition of the existing concrete drive and construction of a new driveway serving the duplex will require a driveway permit under TCM Section 7.
- **Sidewalk construction or fee-in-lieu likely required.** Austin requires a minimum 5-ft sidewalk along frontage on Level 1 streets. Existing sidewalk conditions on Cinchring Ln should be confirmed; if absent or substandard, the developer must construct or pay fee-in-lieu per LDC Section 25-6-354.
- **No scenic roadway, Hill Country Roadway, or Project Connect overlay constraints apply.** The site is well outside all designated scenic corridors, Hill Country Roadway corridors, and Project Connect rail reservation areas.

Findings

1. TIA Not Required

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC Section 25-6-111 through 25-6-117; TCM Section 10; TIA Guidelines Section 2
Finding	The project replaces one single-family unit with a duplex (2 units), yielding a net increase of approximately 1 unit and roughly 9-10 net new daily trips (ITE Land Use 210/220, ~9.4 trips/unit). The TIA threshold is 2,000 unadjusted daily trips. The project is orders of magnitude below this threshold. The Neighborhood Traffic Analysis (NTA) trigger of 300 net new daily trips on a residential street is also not met.
Implication	No TIA, Transportation Assessment, TDM Plan, or NTA is required. No TDS coordination is needed for traffic study purposes.
Recommended next step	None required. No TIA Determination Worksheet filing necessary for a project of this scale.

2. No ROW Dedication Required

Field	Detail
Severity	note

Citation	LDC Section 25-6-51, 25-6-54; ASMP Street Network Table; TCM Section 2
Finding	Cinchring Ln is classified as ASMP Level 1 with a 50-ft ROW standard. The existing platted ROW in the Scofield Subdivision meets this 50-ft standard. The dedication delta is zero. No street deed or plat-based dedication is anticipated.
Implication	The developer retains the full existing lot area; no buildable area is lost to future ROW dedication. Setbacks are measured from the existing property line.
Recommended next step	Confirm existing ROW width against the survey at site plan review. If any discrepancy is identified, the City would require dedication along the frontage as a condition of approval.

3. Driveway Permit Required

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	TCM Section 7 (Driveways), specifically 7.3.1 (driveway types), 7.5.1.2 (width), 7.6 (spacing)
Finding	The existing concrete driveway will be demolished with the house. A new driveway serving the duplex must be permitted under TCM Section 7. On a Level 1 street, a Type I (residential) driveway is permitted. Maximum width is typically 20-24 ft for a two-way residential driveway. A single shared driveway serving both duplex units is the standard configuration and satisfies all spacing requirements. Minimum 30-ft setback from the nearest cross-street curb return applies.
Implication	The driveway permit is a standard requirement but must be coordinated with the building permit timeline. Driveway location must not conflict with TCM spacing standards or the existing 5-ft PUE along the lot line.
Recommended next step	Submit driveway permit application concurrent with building permit. Confirm driveway location relative to any opposing driveways across Cinchring Ln and adjacent lot driveways for offset compliance.

4. Sidewalk Obligation Along Frontage

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	LDC Section 25-6-354 (fee-in-lieu); TCM Section 4.1.6; LDE Residential Review Guidelines (rev. November 2025)

Finding	Austin requires a minimum 5-ft clear-width sidewalk along all street frontages for new residential development on Level 1 streets. Whether Cinchring Ln currently has a sidewalk along the project frontage is not confirmed in the available data. If a sidewalk exists and meets current standards, no action is needed beyond maintaining it. If absent or substandard, the developer must either construct a compliant sidewalk or, if physical constraints exist (trees, drainage, utilities), apply for fee-in-lieu under LDC Section 25-6-354.
Implication	Sidewalk construction adds modest cost and must be coordinated with driveway placement and the 5-ft PUE. If heritage or protected trees are present in the ROW, fee-in-lieu may be the more practical path.
Recommended next step	Conduct a site visit or review aerial imagery to confirm existing sidewalk conditions along the Cinchring Ln frontage. If sidewalk construction is required, incorporate it into the civil site plan. If obstructions exist, pursue fee-in-lieu early in the permitting process.

5. Street Impact Fee Applies

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC Section 25-6-662, 25-6-663(B)
Finding	Street Impact Fees (SIF) apply to virtually all building-permit development in Austin, independent of TIA status. SIF is assessed at plat or building permit application and collected at building permit issuance. For a net increase of one dwelling unit, the fee will be modest but must be accounted for in the project budget.
Implication	SIF is payable at building permit issuance, not at site plan approval. The required cover-sheet note referencing LDC 25-6-662 must appear on plans.
Recommended next step	Submit SIF Estimator Worksheet via ATD KNACK portal to obtain the formal calculation memo prior to building permit application. Budget for SIF in development pro forma.

6. No Scenic Roadway or Hill Country Roadway Overlay

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC Section 25-10-7 (scenic roadways); LDC Section 25-10-81(3) (scenic roadway sign district); LDC Section 25-2-1025/25-2-1127 (Hill Country Roadway)

Finding	Cinchring Ln is not a designated scenic roadway. The site is not within 200 ft of any of the 23 enumerated scenic roadways (LDC Section 25-10-7), nor within 1,000 ft of a Hill Country Roadway corridor. Neither Scofield Ridge Pkwy nor the Parmer Ln segment in this area carries a scenic or Hill Country overlay.
Implication	No scenic roadway sign district constraints, no Hill Country Roadway development standards (40% natural area, grade/cut-fill limits), and no additional sign restrictions apply.
Recommended next step	None required.

7. Limited Transit Access

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	CapMetro system map; Project Connect Orange Line planning documents
Finding	The site has limited transit access. The nearest bus service (CapMetro Routes 392 and 243) operates along Parmer Ln and Tech Ridge, approximately 1.0-2.0 miles away, with 30-60 minute headways. The Red Line commuter rail at Howard Station is approximately 2.5 miles east. The Project Connect Orange Line's planned northern extensions to Parmer/Tech Ridge are future-phase and have no construction timeline. The site is not within an ETOD subdistrict.
Implication	No transit-related development obligations, CapMetro coordination requirements, or bus stop integration work. The site is auto-dependent for practical purposes. No Project Connect ROW reservation applies.
Recommended next step	Informational only. No action required.

8. No Bicycle Facility Construction Required

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	ASMP Bicycle Priority Network; TCM Section 5.1.4
Finding	Cinchring Ln is not on the ASMP Bicycle Priority Network. As a low-speed (25 mph), low-volume Level 1 residential street, shared-lane (bicycle-with-traffic) operation is the applicable standard. No protected bike lane, shared-use path, or neighborhood bikeway construction is required.
Implication	No additional ROW beyond the standard roadway width is needed for bicycle facilities. No impact on site layout or buildable area.

NOETIC

Recommended next step

None required. Note that bicycle parking minimums under LDC Section 25-6-477 still apply citywide — verify required short-term and long-term bicycle parking counts for a duplex use.

9. Parking Minimums — Cross-Reference

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC Sections 25-6-471(B), 25-6-474(A)(3); cross-reference to ZLU discipline
Finding	Austin eliminated general motor-vehicle parking minimums in November 2023. Only accessible parking and bicycle parking minimums survive. For a 2-unit duplex, no minimum number of motor-vehicle parking spaces is required by city code. Accessible parking requirements apply per building code (Appendix A / IBC 1106.5) only if the project meets the threshold for required accessible spaces.
Implication	Parking is at the developer's discretion for unit marketability. Detailed parking analysis is covered in the ZLU discipline.
Recommended next step	See ZLU discipline findings for full parking analysis. Confirm bicycle parking requirements under LDC Section 25-6-477.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Existing sidewalk conditions:** Does a sidewalk currently exist along the project's Cinchring Ln frontage? If so, what is its width and condition? This determines whether new construction, reconstruction, or fee-in-lieu is the appropriate path.
2. **Driveway configuration:** Will the duplex use a single shared driveway or two separate driveways? Confirm proposed driveway location(s) relative to opposing driveways and adjacent lot driveways for TCM Section 7.6 offset compliance.
3. **Survey-confirmed ROW width:** The research assumes the existing platted ROW meets the 50-ft Level 1 standard. Has the boundary survey confirmed the ROW width along the Cinchring Ln frontage, or is this assumption based on plat records alone?
4. **Heritage/protected trees in ROW:** Are there any heritage or protected trees within the ROW or along the property frontage that could constrain sidewalk construction or driveway placement?
5. **SIF estimate:** Has the SIF Estimator Worksheet been submitted to obtain the formal calculation memo? The net-new-unit increment is small, but the fee amount should be confirmed for the pro forma.

Water & Wastewater Findings -- 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 -- Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Assessment date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **Austin Water is the retail provider for both water and wastewater** at this address. The parcel is within Austin's full-purpose city limits with no MUD, PID, or private-utility overlay. Standard AW connection procedures apply.
- **Capital recovery (impact) fees are estimated at up to ~\$15,400** (\$7,700 per service unit x 2 units at the highest published tier). The actual amount may be lower because the Scofield plat dates to the early 1990s and a pre-2018 fee tier may apply; Austin Water makes the final determination.
- **A PE-prepared Utility Tap Plan is required**, with separate water meters and separate wastewater clean-outs for each unit. A ROW permit from Austin Transportation and Public Works is required for service connection installation.
- **An existing concrete sanitary sewer vault on site must be evaluated during demolition planning.** Disposition (removal, capping, or reuse) requires coordination with Austin Water before demolition proceeds.
- **No SER (Service Extension Request) is expected to be required** for a duplex on an existing platted lot with existing utility service, provided the nearest accessible mains are within 100 ft and no capacity concern area applies. However, this must be confirmed with AW correspondence, as Pressure Concern Areas and Wastewater Capacity Concern Areas are administrative designations not visible in public data.

Findings

1. Capital Recovery (Impact) Fees

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	LDC SS 25-9-321; AWU Water Impact Fee Ordinance No. 20111215-115
Finding	Each duplex unit constitutes one service unit. Current published capital recovery fees for lots platted after Oct 1, 2023 are \$4,800 (water) + \$2,900 (wastewater) = \$7,700 per service unit. Two units yield a combined estimate of ~\$15,400. The Scofield plat dates to the early 1990s, so a lower pre-2018 tier may apply, but Austin Water determines the applicable tier at tap-permit application. Tap installation fees, meter fees, and DSD inspection fees are additional and separate from capital recovery fees.
Implication	Budget at least \$15,400 for capital recovery fees in the pro forma, with potential downside if the pre-2018 tier applies. Tap and inspection fees will add several hundred to a few thousand dollars on top. Fees are assessed at the schedule in effect when the tap permit is pulled -- there is no fee lock at SER or other earlier stage.

Recommended next step

Contact Austin Water to confirm the applicable fee tier based on the Scofield plat recording date (Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265). Request a written fee determination before finalizing the pro forma.

2. Utility Tap Plan Requirement

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	UCM 2.6.1; Austin Water New Service Connections
Finding	A Utility Tap Plan prepared by a Texas-licensed Professional Engineer is required for the duplex. The plan must show separate water service connections and meters for each unit, as well as separate wastewater clean-outs per unit. All tap fees must be paid before building permits are issued.
Implication	The PE-prepared tap plan is a prerequisite to building permit issuance. This is a standard process item but must be sequenced early in design to avoid schedule delays.
Recommended next step	Engage a PE to prepare the Utility Tap Plan concurrent with building design. Coordinate with Austin Water's Tap Plan Review team on submission requirements.

3. Separate Meters and Clean-outs Per Unit

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	UCM 2.9.2.E.3 (meter placement); Austin Water service connection standards
Finding	Each duplex unit requires its own water meter and its own wastewater clean-out. Water meters must be placed in the public ROW or in an easement immediately adjacent to ROW; meters inside fences or on private lines are non-compliant. The 5-ft PUE along the lot boundary (per plat) should accommodate meter placement, but the PE should confirm clearances.
Implication	Design must accommodate two meter locations in the ROW/PUE and two clean-out locations on site. This affects site plan layout and yard-line routing.
Recommended next step	Confirm meter placement feasibility within the 5-ft PUE or ROW during tap plan preparation.

4. Existing Concrete Sanitary Sewer Vault

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate

Citation	Austin Water construction standards; City Code Chapter 15-5 (OSSF abandonment procedures, if applicable)
Finding	The site survey identifies an existing concrete sanitary sewer vault on the property. This structure must be evaluated before demolition. Depending on its function and condition, Austin Water may require removal, proper capping, or potentially allow reuse as part of the new service configuration. If the vault is related to a legacy on-site sewage facility (OSSF/septic), formal abandonment under City Code Chapter 15-5 would be required before connecting new service.
Implication	Failure to coordinate with Austin Water on vault disposition before demolition could result in damage to active infrastructure, code violations, or delays. Demolition contractors must be briefed on this constraint.
Recommended next step	Request Austin Water field inspection of the existing vault to determine its function, condition, and required disposition. Incorporate findings into the demolition plan.

5. ROW Permit for Service Connection Installation

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	UCM 3.2.0; Austin Transportation and Public Works ROW permit requirements
Finding	A right-of-way permit from Austin Transportation and Public Works is required before any excavation in the ROW for water or wastewater service connection installation. Plan sets must be delivered at least 2 weeks before the AULCC (Austin Utility Locating Coordinating Committee) meeting for utility coordination review.
Implication	ROW permit timing should be built into the construction schedule. The 2-week AULCC lead time is a sequencing constraint.
Recommended next step	Include ROW permit application in the project schedule; coordinate with the GC to avoid delays at excavation.

6. SER (Service Extension Request) Applicability

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	LDC SS 25-9-33(A); UCM 2.2.3

Finding	An SER is required when the nearest accessible main is >100 ft from the property boundary, the connection is to a transmission main ($\geq 24"$) or interceptor ($\geq 18"$), or the parcel is in a Pressure Concern Area or Wastewater Capacity Concern Area. For a duplex on an existing platted lot with prior SFR service, an SER is unlikely but cannot be ruled out without Austin Water confirmation. Pressure and capacity concern areas are administrative AW designations that are not publicly mapped.
Implication	If an SER is triggered, it adds 3-9 months to the entitlement timeline and does not reserve capacity (UCM 2.2.3(E)). This would be a significant schedule impact for a duplex project.
Recommended next step	Request written confirmation from Austin Water that no SER is required for this address. Specifically ask whether the parcel is in any Pressure Concern Area or Wastewater Capacity Concern Area.

7. Reclaimed Water -- Not Applicable

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC SS 25-9-412
Finding	Mandatory reclaimed water connection under LDC SS 25-9-412 applies only to multifamily (5+ units), mixed-use, and commercial projects. Single-family and duplex projects are exempt. Additionally, the OWRS mandate (GFA $\geq 250,000$ SF) does not apply to a small residential duplex.
Implication	No reclaimed water infrastructure is required. This removes a potential cost and complexity layer.
Recommended next step	None required.

8. No MUD/PID -- City-Served Utilities Confirmed

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	UCM 2.2.1; AW service area GIS
Finding	The Scofield subdivision is within Austin Water's retail service area. No Municipal Utility District (MUD), Public Improvement District (PID), or private utility provider was identified. The parcel is within Austin's full-purpose city limits. No CCN release or transfer through the PUC is needed.
Implication	Standard Austin Water procedures apply without the complications of a third-party provider. This is favorable for schedule and cost certainty.
Recommended next step	None required beyond standard AW coordination.

9. Wastewater Main Size and Gravity Service

NOETIC

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	UCM 2.9.4.G.3 (direct tap prohibition >15"); UCM 2.9.4.J (gravity requirement)
Finding	The size of the wastewater main serving Cinchring Ln was not confirmed during research. If the main exceeds 15 inches, direct service taps are prohibited (UCM 2.9.4.G.3). If the main is a force main rather than gravity, a grinder station at the property line would be required. Given this is a 1990s single-family subdivision, a standard 8-inch gravity main is most likely, but this has not been verified.
Implication	If the main is oversized or non-gravity, additional infrastructure and an SER would be required, adding cost and schedule.
Recommended next step	Verify wastewater main size and type (gravity vs. force) via AW GIS or Austin Water correspondence during tap plan preparation.

10. Existing Utility Easements -- Coordination Required

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	UCM 2.9.1.A.1-A.4; plat records (Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265)
Finding	The lot carries a 5-ft PUE per plat, a blanket electrical easement (Vol. 660, Pg. 968), and a declarant-reserved 10-ft easement right along lot lines (Vol. 11863, Pg. 1147). New water and wastewater service lines must be routed to avoid conflicts with existing easement holders. If AW infrastructure must be placed outside the ROW, a minimum 15-ft-wide easement (or 2x infrastructure depth, whichever is greater) is required with infrastructure centered (UCM 2.9.1.A.1).
Implication	Easement constraints may influence yard-line routing and meter placement. The PE should confirm clearances during tap plan design.
Recommended next step	Review the original plat and all recorded easement instruments. Coordinate with Austin Energy on the blanket electrical easement to avoid conflicts during excavation.

11. Cross-Reference -- Stormwater and Drainage

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	ECM (Environmental Criteria Manual); cross-reference to SDE discipline

NOETIC

Finding	Water quality and stormwater detention requirements are addressed in the SDE (Stormwater, Drainage, and Erosion) discipline. The lot is in an urban watershed (likely Walnut Creek), which has less restrictive impervious cover limits than the Barton Springs Zone. Any rainwater harvesting or condensate reuse that offsets potable demand could also reduce stormwater retention obligations.
Implication	Stormwater and water/wastewater design should be coordinated to identify any synergies (e.g., rainwater capture reducing both potable demand and stormwater volume).
Recommended next step	See SDE discipline findings. Coordinate with civil engineer on integrated site utility and stormwater design.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **SER status confirmation:** Has Austin Water confirmed in writing that no SER is required for a duplex at this address? Is the parcel in any Pressure Concern Area or Wastewater Capacity Concern Area?
2. **Wastewater main size and type:** What is the diameter and type (gravity vs. force main) of the wastewater main in Cinchring Ln? Is a direct service tap permitted, or is the main >15 inches?
3. **Water main size and pressure zone:** What is the diameter of the water main serving the lot, and what pressure zone is the parcel in? Is the main a distribution main (<24 inches) allowing standard meter taps?
4. **Capital recovery fee tier:** What fee tier does Austin Water assign to this lot based on the Scofield plat recording date? Is the pre-2018 schedule applicable?
5. **Sewer vault disposition:** What is the function and condition of the existing concrete sanitary sewer vault? Does Austin Water require removal, capping, or can it be incorporated into the new service design?
6. **Distance to mains:** What is the distance from the property boundary to the nearest accessible water and wastewater mains? Is either >100 ft (SER trigger)?
7. **Yard-line routing:** Given the 5-ft PUE, blanket electrical easement, and declarant's reserved easement rights, are there any conflicts that would constrain the routing of new water and wastewater yard lines or meter placement?
8. **Demolition sequencing:** What is the required sequence for disconnecting existing water and wastewater service, demolishing the existing house and sewer vault, and establishing new service connections? Does Austin Water require a pre-demolition inspection?

Fire Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Jurisdiction:** City of Austin, Full Purpose — Austin Fire Department **Applicable code:** 2024 International Fire Code (adopted via LDC § 25-12-171, Ord. 20250410-039, effective July 10, 2025); building construction governed by IRC (International Residential Code) for duplex (Group R-3 occupancy)

Summary

- **Low overall fire-code risk.** A two-unit duplex built under the IRC on an existing platted lot within a developed suburban subdivision presents a straightforward fire profile with no high-rise, standpipe, NFPA 13, or commercial fire-flow triggers.
- **WUI status is very likely non-applicable.** The site is in a flat, fully urbanized 1990s subdivision with no adjacent wildland; web research and wildfire risk tools indicate low risk. Formal confirmation from AFD Wildfire Division is still required — self-declaration is not accepted.
- **Fire apparatus access is satisfied by existing public street.** Cinchring Ln is a public residential street providing frontage; a two-story duplex footprint well within 150 ft of the street requires no private fire lane, turnaround, or AMOC.
- **Hydrant coverage benefits from the 600-ft R-3 allowance.** Group R-3 occupancies receive the most generous hose-lay distance (600 ft) regardless of sprinkler status. Existing subdivision hydrant infrastructure almost certainly satisfies this, but the nearest hydrant location should be field-verified.
- **Sprinklers are not required** for an IRC duplex unless the building exceeds specific IRC thresholds (e.g., fire area, access limitations). No NFPA 13/13R/13D system is anticipated; no FDC, fire pump, or standpipe applies.

Findings

1. Governing Code Edition

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC § 25-12-171; Ord. 20250410-039
Finding	The 2024 IFC is effective for submittals with an original submission date on or after July 10, 2025. This project, targeting submission in 2026, falls under the 2024 IFC. The duplex itself is constructed under the IRC, not the IBC, as a Group R-3 two-family dwelling.
Implication	Plans and any fire-related notes must reference the 2024 IFC and applicable City of Austin local amendments. Using the 2021 IFC edition would be a deficiency.
Recommended next step	Ensure the permit application and plan sheet notes cite the correct code edition (2024 IFC, IRC for building construction).

2. Fire Apparatus Access

Field	Detail
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Severity	note
Citation	LDC § 25-12-173 §§ 503.1.1, 503.2.1
Finding	Cinchring Ln is an existing public residential street providing direct frontage to the lot. All exterior walls of a duplex on a ~7,840 sq ft lot will be within 150 ft path-of-travel from the street. No private fire apparatus access road, fire lane, or turnaround is required. The project does not trigger aerial apparatus review (max height 35 ft, well below the 73-ft threshold).
Implication	No fire lane design, HS-20 loading analysis, or turnaround geometry is needed. No AMOC for apparatus access distance.
Recommended next step	No action required. Confirm during plan review that the building footprint does not extend beyond 150 ft from the nearest point of fire apparatus access on Cinchring Ln.

3. Hydrant Coverage

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	LDC § 25-12-173 § 507.5.1; UCM § 2.9.2.D
Finding	Group R-3 and Group U occupancies receive a 600-ft hose-lay allowance to all exterior walls, regardless of sprinkler status. Hydrant spacing in non-commercial/non-high-density areas (SF-2 qualifies) is 600 ft maximum interval. Scofield Subdivision, developed in the 1990s, has existing hydrant infrastructure. However, the exact location of the nearest hydrant and its distance to the proposed building have not been field-verified.
Implication	If an existing hydrant is within 600 ft hose-lay of all exterior walls (highly likely in a developed subdivision), no new hydrant or tap is required. No fire flow test is anticipated for an IRC duplex that does not trigger sprinkler or commercial fire-flow requirements.
Recommended next step	Field-verify or confirm via Austin Water GIS the location of the nearest fire hydrant and measure hose-lay distance to the farthest exterior wall of the proposed duplex.

4. Fire-Flow Demand

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	IRC; IFC Appendix B Table B105.1(2) (informational for R-3)

Finding	An IRC duplex (Group R-3, two-family dwelling) does not trigger the commercial fire-flow analysis pathway under the IFC. Fire flow for one- and two-family dwellings is governed by the IRC and the local jurisdiction's residential water supply standards. Austin Water's existing mains in Scofield Subdivision serve the existing SFR and are expected to be adequate for a replacement duplex of comparable scale.
Implication	No AFD fire flow test, no AWWA available-flow calculation, and no fire-flow demand table are required for permit. No AMOC for fire-flow reduction is needed.
Recommended next step	No action required beyond standard Austin Water tap plan review for the new duplex service connections.

5. Sprinkler / Fire Suppression System

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	IRC R313; IFC § 903
Finding	Austin has not adopted a residential sprinkler mandate for IRC one- and two-family dwellings beyond the IRC's own thresholds. A standard two-story duplex does not trigger NFPA 13, 13R, or 13D requirements. No standpipe is required (building height well below 30 ft above lowest FD access). No FDC is required.
Implication	No sprinkler design, FDC siting, fire pump, or riser room is needed. This eliminates significant cost and design complexity.
Recommended next step	None. If the developer voluntarily installs sprinklers (e.g., for insurance benefits), NFPA 13D would be the applicable standard for a two-family dwelling.

6. Building Separation / Fire-Resistance Between Units

Field	Detail
Severity	moderate
Citation	IRC R302.1, R302.2, R302.3
Finding	The zoning pathway confirms that HOME Phase 1 imposes no zoning-based building separation requirement for duplex units. However, the IRC requires fire-separation construction between dwelling units in a duplex: a 1-hour fire-resistance-rated wall assembly from foundation to underside of roof sheathing (IRC R302.2), with no plumbing or mechanical penetrations that compromise the rating. Exterior wall fire-resistance and opening protection depend on fire-separation distance from the property line (IRC R302.1 Table R302.1).

Implication	The architect/designer must detail the party wall (or floor/ceiling assembly if stacked units) to meet IRC fire-separation requirements. This is standard duplex construction but must be explicitly shown on plans. Exterior walls within 3 ft of a property line require 1-hour rating with no openings; walls 3-5 ft require 1-hour rating with limited openings. The 5-ft side setback on this lot will govern the exterior wall treatment.
Recommended next step	During design, confirm fire-separation distance from each side property line and detail the party wall and any exterior walls within 5 ft of a property line for IRC R302.1 compliance.

7. Wildland-Urban Interface (WUI) Status

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	LDC § 25-12-183; FPCM 4.10.0; 2024 WUI Code Map
Finding	Web research indicates Scofield Farms is in a flat, fully urbanized, suburban area with no adjacent wildland of 40+ acres. The area is classified as low wildfire risk. The property is almost certainly outside WUI Zones A, B, and C. However, per Austin's fire feasibility requirements, only AFD Wildfire Division can make the official WUI determination — self-declaration of "not in WUI" is a deficiency.
Implication	If confirmed outside WUI, no ignition-resistant construction, defensible space, or WUI-specific review applies. If unexpectedly within WUI Zone C (the outermost zone), additional exterior material requirements would apply but would not materially affect project feasibility.
Recommended next step	Check the 2024 WUI Code Map via Austin GIS to confirm the property is not within any WUI zone. If any ambiguity, request a written determination from AFD Wildfire Division before permit submission.

8. Knox Box

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	FPCM 4.4.0; IFC § 506.1
Finding	Knox Box is required for commercial structures with fire-protection systems or sites with physical access barriers. A standard IRC duplex without sprinklers, fire alarm, or gated access does not trigger the Knox Box requirement.
Implication	No Knox Box or Knox Switch is needed.
Recommended next step	None.

9. Hazardous Pipeline

NOETIC

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC §§ 25-4-134, 25-2-516
Finding	No hazardous liquid pipeline (49 CFR Part 195, 8-in+ ID) has been identified on or adjacent to the property. Natural gas service (Texas Gas Service, 49 CFR Part 192) does not qualify under the pipeline ordinance.
Implication	No pipeline buffer, setback, or AFD Fire Analysis Table "YES" entry is required.
Recommended next step	None.

10. Construction-Phase Fire Protection

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	IFC § 3313; FPCM 4.4.0 General Note 3
Finding	When combustible materials arrive on site, 500 gpm within 500 ft must be available (IFC § 3313). The existing subdivision hydrant network is expected to satisfy this requirement. The existing hydrant(s) must remain in service throughout demolition and construction.
Implication	Standard construction-phase requirement; no special infrastructure needed. Contractor must not obstruct or disable existing hydrants during demolition or construction.
Recommended next step	Confirm nearest hydrant location is within 500 ft of the construction site and ensure it remains accessible throughout the project.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1. **Nearest hydrant location and distance.** What is the location of the nearest fire hydrant to the proposed duplex, and does the hose-lay path-of-travel to the farthest exterior wall fall within 600 ft? (Field verification or Austin Water GIS confirmation needed.)
2. **WUI map status.** Has the 2024 WUI Code Map been checked for this parcel? If the property appears on the map, has AFD Wildfire Division been contacted for a formal zone determination?
3. **Fire-separation distance at side yards.** With 5-ft side setbacks, will any exterior wall be closer than 3 ft to the property line (e.g., eaves, projections)? This determines whether IRC R302.1 requires a 1-hour-rated exterior wall with no openings versus limited openings.
4. **Party wall construction type.** Has the designer specified the party wall assembly (IRC R302.2 — 1-hour fire-resistance-rated, foundation to underside of roof sheathing, no through-penetrations)? Will the duplex be side-by-side or stacked?
5. **Voluntary sprinklers.** Is the developer considering voluntary NFPA 13D sprinklers for insurance premium reduction or marketability? If so, this would require coordination with Austin Water for a dedicated fire service line and backflow preventer.

Parkland Findings — 12713 Cinchring Ln

Property: 12713 Cinchring Ln, Austin, TX 78727 — Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision **Proposed use:** Demolish existing SFR; build ground-up duplex (2 units) **Lot:** ~7,840 sq ft (0.18 acres), SF-2 zoning **Jurisdiction:** City of Austin, full-purpose city limits **Research date:** 2026-06-03

Summary

- **Parkland dedication does not apply to this project.** Austin’s parkland dedication ordinance (LDC Chapter 25-1, Article 14) triggers at subdivision (for single-family/duplex uses) or at site plan (for multifamily). This project involves building a duplex on an already-platted lot with no subdivision proposed, so parkland dedication is not triggered.
- **No fee-in-lieu is owed.** Neither the single-family fee-in-lieu (LDC 25-1-606) nor the parkland development fee (LDC 25-1-607) applies because no subdivision or plat action is required for this duplex on an existing lot.
- **HOME Phase 1 does not independently trigger parkland obligations.** HOME Phase 1 permits duplexes by right on SF-2 lots through the building permit process; it does not create a new parkland dedication trigger point.
- **No Chapter 26 (Texas Parks & Wildlife Code) concern identified.** No City parkland is immediately adjacent to the lot based on available data. The Scofield Farms neighborhood has existing parks and amenities, but the project does not propose construction on or across any public parkland.
- **This discipline is low-risk for the project.** No parkland-related approvals, fees, or instruments are required for the proposed scope.

Findings

Finding 1: Parkland Dedication Not Triggered — No Subdivision Proposed

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC 25-1-601 through 25-1-612 (effective Jan 1, 2024, per Ord. 20231130-087); LDC 25-1-601(A)-(B) (parkland dedication attaches at site plan for multifamily and at subdivision for single-family residential)
Finding	Parkland dedication for single-family and duplex residential uses is triggered at subdivision (plat approval), not at building permit. This project proposes a duplex on Lot 12, Block M, Scofield Subdivision — an already-platted lot recorded in Cabinet 91, Slides 264-265, Travis County Plat Records. No new subdivision, replat, or plat amendment is proposed as part of the duplex construction. The project proceeds via residential building permit only.
Implication for the developer	No parkland dedication (land or fee-in-lieu) is required. No Parkland Dedication Determination letter from PARD is needed. No parkland-related notes are required on the building permit application.

Recommended next step

No action required. If the project scope changes to include a subdivision or replat (e.g., to take advantage of HOME Phase 2 small-lot provisions to split the lot into two parcels), parkland dedication would be triggered at that point and this finding must be revisited.

Finding 2: HOME Phase 1 Does Not Create a Parkland Trigger

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	Ordinance No. 20231207-001 (HOME Phase 1); LDC 25-1-601(C) (applicability); programs analysis (HOME Phase 1 assessment)
Finding	HOME Phase 1 permits duplexes by right on SF-2 lots and routes them through the residential building permit process — not through site plan or subdivision review. The parkland dedication ordinance's trigger points (site plan for multifamily, subdivision for single-family) are unchanged by HOME. A duplex built under HOME Phase 1 on an existing platted lot does not pass through either trigger point.
Implication for the developer	The developer can proceed with the duplex under HOME Phase 1 without any parkland obligation. No SMART Housing certification or affordability commitment is needed to avoid parkland fees, because no parkland fees apply in the first place.
Recommended next step	None. This is a confirmatory finding.

Finding 3: No Chapter 26 Concern Identified

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	Texas Parks & Wildlife Code, Chapter 26; ECM 5.4.1; ECM 5.4.1 (construction on dedicated parkland triggers Texas Parks and Wildlife Code Chapter 26)
Finding	Chapter 26 applies when any construction activity — including drainage outfalls, utility crossings, grading, or staging — occurs on existing City parkland. Based on available data, Lot 12, Block M does not abut dedicated City parkland. The Scofield Farms neighborhood contains community parks and greenbelts, but no parkland parcel has been identified as immediately adjacent to or abutting this lot. No project work is expected to touch public parkland.
Implication for the developer	No Chapter 26 process (Parks Board hearing, City Council easement, mitigation plan) is anticipated. This avoids a 6-9 month approval timeline that would otherwise be a long-pole schedule item.

Recommended next step	Confirm via Austin GIS parkland layer that no dedicated parkland parcels abut the lot. If any utility connections or drainage discharge routes cross parkland, this finding must be upgraded to significant severity and the Chapter 26 process must be initiated.
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Finding 4: Parkland Adjacency — Verify via GIS

Field	Detail
Severity	data-gap
Citation	ECM 5.4.1; Austin PARD parkland inventory
Finding	The Scofield Farms subdivision includes neighborhood parks and greenbelt areas. The exact proximity of dedicated City parkland to Lot 12 has not been confirmed through GIS or survey data. While Chapter 26 is only triggered by construction on parkland (not merely adjacency), the adjacency question also affects whether PARD would require a pedestrian/bicycle connection if a future subdivision were pursued.
Implication for the developer	Low risk for current scope. If parkland is directly adjacent and the project scope later expands to include subdivision, PARD may require connectivity improvements.
Recommended next step	Check Austin GIS parkland layer to confirm no dedicated parkland abuts the lot. This is a low-priority verification item given the current project scope.

Finding 5: Future Subdivision Would Trigger Parkland Dedication

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC 25-1-601 through 25-1-612; HOME Phase 2 (Ord. 20240516); programs analysis (HOME Phase 2 enables subdivision to lots as small as 2,000 sq ft)
Finding	HOME Phase 2 reduces the minimum lot size to 2,000 sq ft and enables subdivision of existing lots into smaller parcels. If the developer later decides to subdivide this ~7,840 sq ft lot (e.g., into two lots for separate fee-simple ownership of each duplex unit), that subdivision action would trigger parkland dedication. At that point, the single-family parkland calculation would apply: density-based multipliers (LDC 25-1-602(C)), fee-in-lieu (LDC 25-1-606), and parkland development fee (LDC 25-1-607) would all come into play. A Parkland Dedication Determination from PARD would be required.
Implication for the developer	Not applicable to current scope. If subdivision is pursued in the future, budget for parkland fees and the PARD Determination process. For a 2-lot subdivision in a suburban area, the fees are expected to be modest but nonzero.

Recommended next step	No action required unless the project scope changes to include a subdivision. If it does, request a Parkland Dedication Determination from PARD before filing the plat application.
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Finding 6: SMART Housing Parkland Exemption — Not Needed

Field	Detail
Severity	note
Citation	LDC 25-1-601(D)(3) (SMART Housing exemption); LDC 25-1-601(D)(4) (income-restricted unit exemption); programs analysis (SMART Housing assessment)
Finding	SMART Housing certification and income-restricted unit designations exempt units from parkland dedication fees. For larger projects, this is typically the largest available fee reduction lever. However, since this 2-unit duplex project does not trigger parkland dedication at all (no subdivision proposed), the SMART Housing parkland exemption provides no incremental benefit in this context.
Implication for the developer	No need to pursue SMART Housing solely for parkland fee avoidance. SMART Housing may still be worth evaluating for its other benefits (expedited review, fee waivers) per the programs analysis, but parkland is not a factor in that decision.
Recommended next step	None for parkland purposes.

Open Questions for the Engineer

1.	Parkland adjacency confirmation. Can the engineer or surveyor confirm via Austin GIS (PARD parkland layer) whether any dedicated City parkland parcels abut Lot 12, Block M? This would close the data gap in Finding 4 and fully rule out any Chapter 26 risk for utility connections or drainage discharge.
2.	Future subdivision intent. Is there any possibility the developer will pursue a lot split or subdivision (e.g., under HOME Phase 2 small-lot provisions) to sell the duplex units on separate lots? If so, parkland dedication analysis should be revisited at that time, and a PARD Parkland Dedication Determination should be requested before plat application.
3.	Drainage discharge routing. Does the proposed drainage plan route any discharge through or across public parkland or greenbelt areas? If so, Chapter 26 would be triggered regardless of the parkland dedication analysis above.

This assessment is based on the Austin LDC as amended through Ord. 20231130-087 (parkland dedication, effective Jan 1, 2024) and Ord. 20231207-001 (HOME Phase 1, effective Feb 5, 2024). Verify current ordinance status with Austin Development Services before relying on these findings for permit applications.